



MINISTRY OF HEALTH: STRATEGIC PLAN 2024-2026

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MINISTRY OF HEALTH
STRATEGIC PLANNING FOR 2024 - 2026

SHIPMENT

Ensuring a health system of the country that is human-centered, that emphasizes prevention and aims to strengthen the social contribution through the continuous upgrading of the services provided with professionalism and respect, equally to all citizens.

VISION

Quality health services to all citizens and for their entire life span.

VALUES

A. Values in relation to contribution to society

- i. **Social offering:** Provision of health services centered on people and society at large, with respect to their needs and with a view to collective well-being, environmental protection, safeguarding the public interest and investing in future generations.
- ii. **Equality in health:** Creation of the appropriate infrastructures and systems that ensure equal access of citizens to health services and ensure equal rights and treatment, away from any kind of discrimination.
- iii. **Quality in health:** Effective management of health services, taking into account the parameters of structure, processes and results, with the aim of providing upgraded health services, in order to achieve the greatest benefit at the least cost to the patient. iv. **Improving quality of life with an emphasis on prevention:** Health care with an emphasis on providing services and developing programs that prevent disease, improve and promote human health.

B. Internal Values of the Organization

- i. **Excellence:** Organization of work and development of programs, with the aim of promoting research, innovation and new technology, to expand scientific knowledge and develop a culture of excellence in the services provided.
- ii. **Integrity:** Defining and improving interpersonal relationships based on a sense of justice, guided by the principles of consideration, fairness, proportionality, good faith and discretion. iii. **Efficiency:** Rational use of available resources (budget, equipment, infrastructure, human resources), for the optimal provision of health services to citizens.
- iv. **Professionalism:** Behavior of the staff, in a way that inspires trust and maturity, with respect to the applicable Laws and Regulations, the views of their colleagues and the rights of the citizen.
- v. **Respect:** Development of the principles of respect, responsibility, confidentiality and compliance with Laws and Regulations, with the acceptance of diversity, both in communication with colleagues and in communication and service to citizens.
- vi. **Teamwork:** Development of collective work among staff, on the basis of an interactive and constructive dialogue and cooperation for the benefit of the citizen, but also of society as a whole.

STRATEGIC PURSUITS

- i. Restructuring of the Country's Health System.**
- ii. Strengthening and Upgrading Electronic Health (eHealth).**
- iii. Strengthening the Active and Effective Presence in the European and International Events.**
- iv. Promoting Health Promotion and Disease Prevention across the Lifespan.**
- v. Management, Training and Development of Human Resources in the field of Health.**
- vi. Development of Research, Technological Development and Innovation Activities.**

GOAL 1: OPTIMUM FUNCTIONING OF THE HEALTH SYSTEM**1. EXISTING CONDITION**

The passing of the Laws and Regulations on the Organization of State Health Services marked the gradual start of the implementation of the autonomy of Public Hospitals and Primary Health Care Centers,

At the same time, with the passing of the "General Health System (Amendment) Law of 2017", the introduction of the NHS was completed in two phases. The first phase was introduced on June 1, 2019 and concerns the Application of Outpatient Health Care (introduction of personal physician services, specialist physician services, laboratory tests and medications). Since June 2020, the full implementation of the NHS has been promoted (introduction of inpatient health care services, TAEP, Ambulances, Nurses, Midwives, other health professionals, and preventive dental care).

In addition, in 2019, the e-health legislation was passed by the House of Representatives, while the bills for the establishment of University Clinics and for the Establishment and Operation of Rehabilitation and Recovery Centers are before the House of Representatives, for discussion and passing them into laws. A number of other pieces of legislation are being processed to strengthen the new role that the Ministry of Health is taking on in the field of Health of Cyprus.

At the same time, the COVID-19 pandemic, as in other countries, highlighted further challenges in the health sector and needs for health system recovery and resilience. Therefore, the Ministry of Health, in collaboration with its affiliated Organizations (Health Insurance Organization, OKYpY and National Electronic Health Authority) and Departments, proceeded to include a number of investments and reforms in the Recovery and Resilience Plan 2021-2026 aimed at increasing efficiency, accessibility and overall system resilience, with specific measures to develop policies and monitor key metrics to support data-driven decisions that lead to ensuring adequate supplies and infrastructure that will improve the capacity of hospital units and conditions work of health personnel. These investments and reforms concern the upgrading of the quality of the health care services provided through the creation of a National Center for Clinical Documentation,

the accreditation of provided healthcare services and the upgrading of medical technology and medical devices in hospitals, the development of electronic health (eHealth) solutions, the development of electronic surveillance of hospital consumption of antibiotics and healthcare - related infections, the gradual shift of the provision framework health care and reimbursement to value-based models in the context of the NHS, in the development of an innovative ICT public health information system in the general framework of monitoring and control of communicable diseases and preparedness for any pandemic and in the creation of infrastructure and equipment that will serve for the benefit of patients and healthcare workers, the functionality of hospitals and public health authorities (Investment measures). The implementation of the projects has been assigned to the Departments of the Ministry of Health, to the Health Ministry, to the National Electronic Health Authority and to the OAU, based on competence, while their implementation has begun based on specific agreed milestones.

All of the above contributed to the disengagement of the Ministry of Health from the process of organization and provision health care services and the need to strengthen its responsibilities for planning, organizing, managing and regulating the health system, aiming at its optimal functioning. For the most efficient fulfillment of these responsibilities, it is proceeding with its restructuring and rational staffing based on the relevant study of the World Bank (2014)¹ and its updating, a study whose completion has been delayed due to the

¹ World Bank (2014) Analysis of the Function and Structure of the Ministry of Health of the Republic of Cyprus, Washington DC: The World Bank
[http://www.crcs.gov.cy/crcs/crcs.nsf/0/19C93F7040511146C2257E34002F8B4E/\\$file/Final%20Report%20MOH.pdf](http://www.crcs.gov.cy/crcs/crcs.nsf/0/19C93F7040511146C2257E34002F8B4E/$file/Final%20Report%20MOH.pdf)

of the COVID-19 pandemic and has been handed over to the Ministry of Health in early August 2023 and which is being studied. Until making final decisions, the activities of the Central Administration of the Ministry of Health remain the same and concern:

- In the **coordination of the implementation of the Strategy of the Ministry of Health in matters of Health Policies**. The preparation of the Strategy constitutes the document for the formulation of the policy with the planning, monitoring and evaluation of its implementation. An important role in the development of this Strategy is played by the Health Monitoring Unit at the Administration level, which collects and analyzes data and provides basic health information to the Ministry of Health itself, as well as to other involved bodies. In addition, the further development and strengthening of the Ministry's European and International Relations, harmonization with the EU acquis and its effective participation in European Programs, continue to be priority issues for the Ministry of Health. With the ultimate aim of strengthening its regulatory and supervisory role, the Department of Health has secured advisory services from the (non-profit) public law organization Northern Ireland Co-operation Overseas (NI-CO) through the European Commission's DG Reform, for development of a strategy as well as an operational plan for planning the needs and its capabilities in the health sector of Cyprus. The project covers issues of health professionals, health infrastructure and equipment, public and private sector in our country.
- To the **Directorate of Nursing Services** of the Ministry of Health as it is the point of reference, as the competent authority, for the Nursing and Midwifery profession, as well as for the Nursing and Midwifery staff. The main role of the Directorate is to define the Nursing and Midwifery Policy at the national level, both in the public and in the private sector, with participation in decision-making on all matters related to Nursing and Midwifery, but also in general with the public health. The Directorate of Nursing Services, following the current legislation on Nursing and Midwifery 1988, the international literature and practice, the recommendations of the European Union, the Council of the EU, the declarations of International Organizations such as the World Health Organization, the International Council of Nurses, contributes to the optimal operation of the Health System, with the ultimate goal of ensuring continuous provision of quality nursing and midwifery care to the population.
- In the promotion of **electronic health** through the Informatics Group of the Deputy Ministry of Research, Innovation and Digital Policy, which is active at the level of the Ministry's Administration. Currently, the Ministry of Health has a significant number of IT systems in operation.
- In the operation of the **Subsidized Patients** Sector and the **Application of Patients' Rights in Cross-Border Health Care**, the **Issuance of Nursing Identities**, the **application of the European Regulations for the Coordination of Social Security Systems** and specifically the health insurance and Invoicing of European Patients. The Sector, which absorbed a large percentage of the Ministry's Budget, is expected to be fully computerized very soon with the implementation of new modern program software. The work of this Sector includes the following:
 - i. The implementation of the Plan to Provide Financial Assistance for Health Services that are not offered in the Public Sector. The Department is responsible for sending patients who need health services, which are not provided within the NHS. These missions concern both the private sector of the Republic of Cyprus and abroad (European Union Member States and Third Countries), as well as the referrals of specialized doctors to public hospitals for operations or treatments that are not carried out by doctors or hospitals contracted with the GeSY.
 - ii. The implementation of the legislation concerning the Rights of patients in the context of Cross-Border of Health Care (Law 149(1)/ 2013). Law 149(I)/2013, as amended from time to time, established the framework for the implementation of cross-border health care in the Republic of Cyprus, both as an insurance member state and as a treatment member state, with the aim of facilitating the exercise of patients' rights.

- iii. The Issuance of Nursing IDs for services not provided by the NHS, as well as for beneficiaries of medical care who cannot register with the NHS (determining a public billing system for health care services, hospital fees, health care provision, policy making, solving problems related to with the sector, etc.).
- iv. The issuance of a European Health Insurance Card and, in general, the processing of all procedures provided for in the European Regulations for the Coordination of Social Security Systems, including the issuance of documents, record keeping and information exchange with other European insurance bodies.

- In the **Blood Center and Blood Vigilance function**. The laboratories of the Blood Center are located in the Nicosia General Hospital, while there are Blood Donation Stations in all the provinces. The project concerning the construction of new facilities for the Blood Center with the provision of relevant equipment has been included in the European Union's Recovery and Resilience Plan and started to be implemented in 2023 with a completion milestone in 2025. It will house the Administration and laboratories of the Blood Center and will have a blood donation station. The Blood Center is the body responsible for the collection and control of human blood or blood components, whatever their intended use, as well as their processing, storage and distribution when intended for transfusion. The needs of the population in blood derivatives are served all over Cyprus. Approximately 64,000 units of whole blood are collected annually and approximately 63,000 packed red blood cells, 8,500 units of platelets and 13,500 units of fresh frozen plasma are prepared. The recording and monitoring of adverse events and reactions, as well as the participation in Transfusion committees in the hospitals is part of the activities of the Blood Banks and the Blood Center in the context of hemovigilance.

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Coordination of the Policy and Planning Strategy (including monitoring and evaluation) - Reforms in the Country's Health System

The Ministry of Health is the main contributor and coordinator of the country's health system. In order to achieve the optimal functioning of the health system, especially in the context of the reforms in the health sector that have been implemented or are in progress, in view of the planned restructuring of the Ministry of Health, a revised strategy of the Ministry of Health will be prepared in policy matters, taking into account the constantly changing data in the health sector, including the effects on it from other factors, such as pandemics or other political and economic instabilities.

The actions concerning the autonomy of public hospitals, the modernization of Primary Health Care have progressed and been undertaken by the State Health Services Organization, with the Ministry of Health and its involved Departments and Directorates supporting its work. The action concerning the implementation of the NHS has already been promoted.

The rest of the reforms in the country's health system are in the implementation phase and concern:

- I. **reorganization of the Ministry of Health, (on the basis of an updated study by the World Bank)**
- II. **introduction of eHealth** (which is a separate activity of Objective 1 and described below),

- III. **establishment of University Clinics**, with the relevant bill having been submitted to the House of Representatives and in the context of its discussion to promote its re-consultation.

- IV. **Establishment of a National Clinical Documentation Center** with funding from the Recovery and Resilience Plan 2021-2026. The main objective of the Project is to prepare, control and evaluate by a group of experts, at least 90 clinical protocols, based on evidence-based medicine and Clinical Practice Guidelines (CPG). Through the project, it is sought to improve the efficiency of health service providers and the simultaneous preservation and sustainability of the health system.

The creation of a National Pharmaceutical Authority is being studied in accordance with the recommendations of the World Bank included in its report (May 2014). This Organization is expected to undertake and upgrade the regulatory role of the state in the field of medicines and cosmetic products, as well as

medical technology products. It will also have the responsibility of implementing relevant controls, inspections and market surveillance, as well as providing information that will contribute to the safe and effective use of these products by citizens.

The Health Monitoring Unit (HMU) plays an important role in defining, developing and monitoring the various health policies at the level of the Administration, through the collection and analysis of data and the provision of important health information.

At the same time, the definition and implementation of policies regarding the European and International relations of the Ministry of Health is important. The Department of European Affairs of the Ministry of Health facilitates and promotes the most effective coordination of the Departments/Services of the Ministry of Health in matters of its responsibilities (Public Health, Medicines, Medical Equipment and Food). This coordination is achieved in the context of a continuous and two-way cooperation, both between the Departments, as well as with the Permanent Representation of the Republic of Cyprus in the EU and with other involved bodies. Accordingly, in the field of International Relations, the Ministry Health aims to strengthen bilateral and other relations and has so far concluded a large number of Bilateral Agreements and Memoranda of Understanding, with cooperation focusing mainly on the exchange of expertise.

In addition, the organization of the Ministry's processes with the aim of strengthening the Structures, Capacity Development (Capacity Planning) and the introduction of supporting tools such as Health Technology Assessment (ATY), are being rolled out as important elements of the Strategy in policy matters. The project of developing a strategy, as well as an operational plan for planning the needs and possibilities in the health sector of Cyprus, covers six pillars related to:

- Health Care Regulation - Health Needs Assessment - Quality Data System-Minimum Data Set - Health Facilities Audit - Planning needs and possibilities in service or hospital level (Local level demand and capacity planning)
- Human Resources Planning

This Activity also includes:

- I. Strengthening and expanding the activities of the Health Monitoring Unit including, among others, the expansion of records and the completion of the bill On the Establishment of a Health Monitoring Unit
- II. Promotion of Medical Tourism in coordination with the Deputy Ministry of Tourism and in collaboration with Non Government Organizations (NGOs), Private Hospitals, Universities and other Institutes.
- III. Establishment of a Country Office of the World Health Organization (WHO) in Cyprus, which is expected to assist the Ministry. Health in areas where expertise is needed which is now made accessible through this collaboration with the WHO.
- IV. Improvement and upgrading of the offered training of specialist doctors in the hospitals of Cyprus, with the aim of forming a revised and modernized framework of medical education in the context of the corresponding changes in the training system of specialist/specialist doctors in Greece. Also, the promotion of the review and modernization of the existing legal framework governing the training of qualified doctors.
- V. Ensuring the orderly operation and upgrading of the services related to the affiliated organizations (OAU, OKYPY, EAHY, OKTK, ING, etc.)
- VI. Ensuring the proper functioning of the Blood Center and Blood Vigilance Service, by collecting and controlling human blood or blood components, whatever their intended use, as well as their processing, storage and distribution when intended for transfusion , as well as the promotion of transfusion safety and the optimal management of blood derivative stocks in Cyprus.

ACTIVITY 2: Directorate of Nursing Services

The Directorate of Nursing Services, in the context of the implementation of the strategic objectives of the Ministry of Health and the general reforms of the Health System, continues its role and responsibilities for its optimal operation, with the ultimate goal of ensuring the continuous provision of quality nursing care to the population. These activities include the following:

- Department of Quality Levels, Design and Research:
 - o Development of Nursing and Midwifery Policy, o Ensuring Continuous Quality Nursing and Midwifery Care, o Development of Clinical Guidelines, o Promotion of Nursing and Midwifery Research and Evidence-Based Practice, o Conducting Internal Audit.
- Department of Human Resources Management and Development:
 - o Ensuring Continuous Education and Professional Development of the nursing and midwifery staff, in accordance with current legislation, through the Department's Education Department.
 - o Clinical Placement/ Training/ Guidance of Nursing and Midwifery students in collaboration with Universities.
 - o Management of permanent staff and permanent and fixed-term employees (General Nursing Branch, Mental Health Nursing Branch and Health Visitor Branch) and obstetric staff, who were hired by the Ministry of Health, including staff seconded to the State Services Organization (OKYpY) with the autonomy of State Hospitals from 1/1/2019.
- Participation in National Strategies/Committees and Development of Health Promotion and Prevention Programs and Population Controls:
 - o Through the Health Visitor Services, at the Immunization and Maternity Centers for the uninsured and immigrants, at the Kokkinotrimithia Refugee Reception Center, at the Asylum Seeker Reception Center, at the Prisons, at school units including pilot daily coverage in three secondary schools in remote areas and at the Adult and Traveler Centers.
 - o Through the Mental Health Nursing staff for programs aimed at promoting mental health and addiction prevention in municipalities, communities and schools in collaboration with the Cyprus Addictions Authority, the Pan-Cyprus Anti-Drug Association and the Ministry of Education, Sports and Youth.
 - o Participation in National Strategies/Committees related to public health, Promotion of Maternal Breastfeeding and "Baby Friendly Hospitals" Initiative, Addressing Addiction, Disability, Prevention of Child Accidents and Poisoning, Establishing the European Guarantee, for Children's Rights of Children in Health, Research Promotion Committee of the Ministry of Health, Rare Diseases, National Vaccination Advisory Committee of the Ministry of Health, etc.

ACTIVITY 3: Electronic Health - eHealth (including IT)

Through the Electronic Health Law (L. 59(I) 2019), the National Electronic Health Authority (EAHY) was established, which is a legal entity under public law and is expected to regulate the functionality of digital transformation level 2 at national and cross-border level . Therefore, the National Electronic Health Authority is financed through its own budget which is currently covered by a state grant granted to it by the Ministry of Health, while it is at the stage of preparing a corresponding Strategic Plan based on the provisions of the Fiscal Responsibility Law.

The Ministry will continue the operation of the existing applications of its various Sectors/Units, with the support of the IT Services Department of the Deputy Ministry of Research, Innovation and Digital Policy, such as: • the Archive system in various Departments of the Ministry of Health, • the issuance of IDs Hospitalization and the European Health Insurance Card, • the Patient Subsidy Scheme, Administrative Fines and other systems in Health Services, the

Data Warehouse for the Health Monitoring Unit and other Databases.

- Laboratory Information Management System for the State General Chemistry • Various systems of the Pharmaceutical and Health Services
- The continuation of the operation of the existing applications and systems in its various Departments Ministry of Health.

It will also continue to operate the Platforms linked to Covid-19 such as:

- Platform for the European Digital COVID Certificate of the Ministry of Health (EU Digital COVID Certificate - EUDCC),
- Platform for the European Digital COVID Certificate of the Ministry of Health (EU Digital COVID Certificate - EUDCC) until it is transferred to the World Health Organization's global digital health certification network
- SNOW (registration and management of patients with COVID-19) and

At the same time, there are a number of other IT systems that must be promoted at the level of the Ministry of Health and which concern the following:

- Information System for Population Control Programs.
- Electronic update of Health Monitoring Unit files (Electronic certificate of causes death and/or birth record and/or cancer record).
- System for recording and managing applications for hearing aid subsidy (implementation by Medical Services and Public Health Services).
- Cyprus Innovative Public Health ICT System (CIPHIS) (implemented by Medical Services and Public Health Services, funded by the Recovery and Resilience Plan).
- Platform for Surveillance of Nosocomial Antibiotic Consumption and Nosocomial Infections (implemented by Medical Services and Public Health Services, funded by the Recovery and Resilience Plan).

Finally, in the context of the Ministry of Health's efforts to expand electronic health, the projects of the New Integrated Health Information System (IHS) and the Digitization of the medical file are being promoted in all Public Hospitals / Health Centers, which are expected to be transferred immediately to the State Health Services Organization (OKYpY).

ACTIVITY 4: Subsidized Patients and Cross-Border Healthcare / Pricing of European Patients

This Activity covers the following processes:

i. Patient Subsidy based on European Regulations 883/04 and 987/09 and the implementation of Directive 2011/24/EU on the Implementation of Patients' Rights in Cross-Border Healthcare:

A) Patient subsidy based on European Regulation 883/04 and Form S2 or patient subsidy for missions to specialized medical centers in third countries: This service concerns highly specialized health services that are not provided on the territory of the Republic of Cyprus. Patients are sent on priority, with the issuance of Form S2, to hospitals in member states of the European Union, which are contracted to the National Health System of the country and where this is not possible to private centers within the European Union or to specialized centers in third countries. These services are provided based on the provisions of the existing Financial Assistance Plan for Health Services that are not offered in the Public Sector.

B) Implementation of Patients' Rights in Cross-Border Healthcare: the provision of services is based on Directive 2011/24/EU on the implementation of Patients' Rights in the context of Cross-Border Healthcare, as it has been transposed into National Law and the works of the Unit relate to the following:

(a) in the establishment and control of the National Contact Point for the provision of information on the rights of patients in cross-border healthcare, the management of cost reimbursement forms, pre-authorization, information on complaints/complaints, control and management of the website of the National Contact Point etc.

(b) in the revision of the existing national (L.149(I)/2013) legislation based on the EU acquis,

(c) in meeting the obligations arising from the European Directive (preparation/drafting of annual reports on the implementation of the Directive, preparation of questionnaires) as well as cooperation with the other EU Member States (exchange of information, responses to requests, exchange of knowledge, etc.) .l.p).

- ii. **Patient Subsidy based on the provisions of the Financial Assistance Plan for Health Services not offered in the Public Sector.** The service in question concerns health services that are not provided within the framework of the NHS, but it is possible to process them on the territory of the Republic of Cyprus.

(a) summoning specialized doctors to public hospitals to carry out specific interventions/treatments.

(b) sending to private sector hospitals for specific and/or specialized operations and treatments, which have not yet been included in the NHS.

(c) sending to private sector hospitals for specific and/or specialized operations and treatments, for which there is, at the present stage, no capacity within the NHS or in cases where the hospitals within the NHS cannot provide them, within the specific time frames limits that are medically acceptable based on the medical assessment of his health condition, the required health service.

ACTIVITY 5: Directorate of Purchases and Supplies

The Directorate of Purchases and Procurement (DAP) is responsible for conducting tenders to meet the needs of the Ministry of Health and its departments in equipment, consumables and services in the following subjects:

- i. Blood Center,
- ii. blood banks,
- iii. Forensic Service,
- iv. Scholarly Service,
- v. Dental Services,
- vi. Public Health Services,
- vii. Pandemic COVID-19.

DAP also conducts public health tenders, such as the purchase of vaccines to combat the pandemic and the securing of new innovative pharmacotherapies as follows:

- On a nominal basis, patient requests for new innovative treatments within the framework of special Committees, patient approvals for drugs not included in the List of the Health Insurance Organization (OHI) and patient approvals for drugs that are innovative and now on the market.
- Medicines and drugs that are not covered by the NHS.
- Food products intended for special medical purposes.
- Medicines for the Infertile Couples Subsidy Scheme.
- Medicines for groups of patients who are entitled to free treatment and are not beneficiaries of the NHS.
- Vaccines according to the new vaccination schedule for children and adolescents following the decision of the Vaccination Advisory Committee.
- Vaccines according to the new vaccination scheme for adults and vulnerable groups after the decision of the Vaccination Advisory Committee.

DAP also satisfies the requests of the State Health Services Organization in pharmaceutical products, as well as requests of the OAU in pharmaceutical products, until the completion of the entry management contracts by the OAU. It also conducts tenders to cover any shortages in the country.

GOAL 2: PROMOTION OF HEALTH AND PREVENTION OF DISEASE

1. EXISTING CONDITION

The Europe 2020 Strategy recognizes health as a very important, indirect factor to achieve smart, sustainable and inclusive growth. Investments in health promotion and disease prevention have positive effects not only for citizens, but also for the financial sustainability of the health system. To maintain health, the development of targeted health promotion and disease prevention strategies is very important. This is also recognized in the existing literature and publications of the EU and International Organizations.

Health promotion and disease prevention are key axes of the Ministry of Health's strategy. The Administration of the Ministry is responsible for the development of strategies and policies for health promotion, prevention and early diagnosis of diseases aimed at the general population, with an emphasis on the development of programs aimed at specific age and vulnerable groups of the population.

Given the increased needs for medical care which are an extension of financial conditions and the aging of the population, the Ministry of Health has already developed and implemented strategies for health promotion, prevention and treatment of diseases throughout the human life span, numbering over part of public health issues.

The Strategy of the Ministry of Health also includes the organization and operation of early detection population programs aimed at specific ages of the population. With the introduction of the General Health Plan, the implementation of screening programs remains the responsibility of the Ministry of Health until the confirmation of the patient's diagnosis, in which case the provision of health care will be covered under the NHS. Colon Cancer Population Screening aims to reduce mortality by detecting cancer at an early stage and removing polyps at an acceptable cost.

The Ministry of Health offers for free on a pan-Cypriot basis, the Population Program for the Early Detection of Breast Cancer, the first cancer in frequency, to women aged 45-74. For the period 2016-2020, the average of new cases of breast cancer in Cyprus amounts to six hundred and forty (640) cases. One hundred and thirty two (132) people died from this condition during the period 2017-2021. The average of new cancer cases per year is 3923 and deaths are 6500 per year. The program was developed according to the European Guidelines. Today, five Mammography Centers operate, one in each province, with upgraded equipment and infrastructure and with increased staffing. In the field of Breast Cancer management, the Ministry includes among its priorities the continuation and improvement of the operation of the Specialized Breast Center at the Nicosia General Hospital on the basis of European and International Guidelines, investing in the ongoing training of the officers who staff the Center, in assistance with specialized equipment and coordinated incident management.

The population screening program for the early detection of Colon Cancer was piloted by the Ministry of Health in March 2013. The first results from the evaluation of the program are considered very encouraging and recognize that it contributes to the early diagnosis of a large number of cases, as also in their effective treatment. Based on the data maintained by the Health Monitoring Unit of the Ministry of Health, the average of new cases of colon cancer in Cyprus for the period 2016-2020, amounts to three hundred and ninety two (392) cases. One hundred and thirty nine (139) people died from this condition during the period 2017-2021. It is noted that colon cancer is considered the third leading cause of death from all types of cancer in both sexes. The program, which will cover the entire population aged 50-74, is expected to be implemented in October 2023. A corresponding program for prostate cancer is expected to be implemented in December 2023, while a detection program for the early detection of cervical cancer of the matrix is estimated to be introduced in 2024.

In its individual activities, the Ministry of Health adopts the "Health in all Policies" approach and establishes cooperation with all involved bodies (including Non-Governmental

Organizations) in the process of developing strategies and policies. For this purpose, it also implements a Plan to provide Grants to Non-Governmental Organizations and Committees active in the health sector, based on specific criteria, on an annual basis.

In addition, the Ministry of Health, responding to European guidelines, develops and implements through the Resuscitation Services actions and collaborations to reduce deaths after sudden cardiac arrest.

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Develop and implement Strategies for health promotion and disease prevention

The implementation of strategies continues, such as for the promotion of Maternal Breastfeeding, the treatment of Rare Diseases, Diabetes, Sexual and Reproductive Health, Thalassemia and other hemoglobinopathies, as well as an Action Plan for the prevention of Child Accidents and Poisoning. In addition, the Ministry of Health has proceeded with the revision of the National Strategies for Cancer and Rheumatic Diseases for the years 2019-2023 and subsequently in their implementation by the National Committees that have been established. The National Strategy for the Health of the Elderly has been completed and the Strategy for the Promotion of Natural Childbirth and the Prevention of Prematurity and the Strategy for the Prevention of Cardiovascular Diseases are in the finalization phase. and, in the preparation of a strategy-plan of action for patient safety.

The Resuscitation Services of the Ministry of Health aim to save human life after sudden cardiac arrest by implementing a central system of continuous reporting and control of the quality and effectiveness of cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) services, inside and outside the hospital. The Revitalization Services aim at collaborations with various bodies, such as professional associations, educational bodies, non-profit organizations, public services and services of the wider public sector and at the development of joint actions and partnerships for the implementation of the objectives related to the issues of revitalization as well as the text legislation regulating the installation, registration and use of Automated External Defibrillators.

ACTIVITY 2: Early Detection/Diagnosis

The Population Programs Unit, whose operation has been approved in March 2022 by the Council of Ministers, focuses on the early detection and diagnosis of diseases through cancer prevention and detection programs, which are among the main policy activities of the Ministry of Health.

This activity includes the following:

- i. Introduction of a Population Program for the Early Detection of Colon Cancer in all citizens aged 50-74.
- ii. Continuation of the Population-Based Breast Cancer Early Detection Program (including training and retraining of Doctors and other health professionals), centralization of the mammography program through the network connection of the Mammography Centers with the Ministry of Health, preparation of information material for the purposes of informing and raising public awareness, accreditation of the program and interconnection of information with the patient's medical file WOW
- iii. Introduction of a new comprehensive electronic infrastructure for all population-based early detection programs, which has been financed by the European Structural Funds.
- iv. Policy setting for the introduction of a screening program for prostate and cervical cancer of the uterus.

At the same time, the introduction of a screening program for the diagnosis of Autism Spectrum Disorders and the expansion of screening programs for newborns (additional 8 diseases) are being promoted.

PERFORMANCE AND PERFORMANCE INDICATORS - CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

Objective (S) / Activity (D)	Performance Index (S) /Performance (D)	Result the index - 2021	Description
P1: Optimal Functioning of the Health System	<u>DE01:</u> Level of satisfaction of GeSY Beneficiaries		The index refers to the evaluation of the level of satisfaction of the beneficiaries with the provided health services.
	<u>DE02:</u> Improvement of the basic health indicators of the Cypriot population		These indicators are provided by the Health Monitoring Unit of the Ministry of Health.
D01: Coordination of Strategy in Policy and Planning matters (including Monitoring and evaluation)- Reforms in the country's Health system	<u>DA01:</u> Percentage of reforms that have been implemented under the roadmap		Phases of the reforms that have been implemented in relation to those mentioned in the road map of the reforms, for each of them.
	<u>DA02:</u> DA02: Reduction of the time of registration, processing and dissemination of the data produced by the Health Monitoring Unit. With valid and timely dissemination of public health data, the Ministry will be able to make policy decisions based on the most recent data.		In order to achieve this specific activity, an upgrade of existing software is required as well as the creation of new electronic software, which will help in the timely registration of the data collected and analyzed by the Health Monitoring Unit. At this stage, the collection of data on the causes of death, cancer and births is done using forms, followed by electronic registration and, by extension, the processing, analysis and dissemination of data.
D02: Directorate of Nursing Services	<u>DA03:</u> The percentage (%) of the checks that will be carried out by the Nursing Services Directorate annually in relation to the total number of departments provided services by the Health Visiting Officers/Nursing Officers.		The percentage of nursing audits that will be carried out by the Nursing Services Directorate annually, in relation to the total number of departments served by the Health Visiting Officers/Nursing Officers.

3. Electronic Health - eHealth (including IT)	DA04 Percentage (%) of completion of phases of the Project in relation to the IT system for Population Control Programs		Project Phase
			% phase completion
			Completion of tender documents and terms of reference
			Control of tender documents by the General Accounting Office (circular GL/ADD5 70)
			Tender Announcement
			Submit an offer
			Bid evaluation
			Announcement of Competition Results
			Tender Review Authority
			Final Assignment/Award
D04: Subsidized Patients and Cross-Border Healthcare / Nursing Identities / Billing of European Patients	DA05 Average patient response time.		Project Start
			Integration
D05: Supplies	DA06 Percentage (%) of the total value and / or number of emergency tenders		Number of days elapsed from the date of submission of the application to the date of response (time required to respond to the patient).
P2: Health Promotion and Disease Prevention	DE03: Percentage of increase in score on the WHO EPHO 4 (health promotion) / EPHO 5 (disease prevention) self-assessment tool		Percentage (%) of the final value and/or number of urgent tenders compared to the final value and/or number of all tenders. Urgent tenders are tenders with completion in a period of one month or less.
			Score achieved on the WHO Self-Assessment Tool - EPHO 4 (health promotion) /EPHO 5 (disease prevention) compared to what has been achieved in 20152 .

D06: Development and implementation of Strategies for health promotion and disease prevention	<u>DA07:</u> Percentage of strategies in the three-year strategy that have been completed.		The number of strategies that have been developed since the beginning of the three-year strategy, compared to the number of strategies that were planned to be developed.
<u>D07:</u> Early Detection / Diagnosis	<u>DA08:</u> Population response rate to screening programs for breast/colon cancer.		The number of people who respond to the invitation and are screened through the screening programs, relative to the number of people who are invited to participate in the program.

GRAPHIC SUMMARY 2024 - CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION - BY OBJECTIVE

DEPARTMENT: MEDICAL AND PUBLIC HEALTH SERVICES

OBJECTIVE 1: PROMOTION AND PROTECTION OF PUBLIC HEALTH / PREVENTION OF DISEASE AND IMPROVING THE QUALITY OF CITIZENS' LIFE

1. EXISTING CONDITION

The Department of Medical Services and Public Health Services (MPH) is responsible for monitoring the health of the population, the factors that affect it, the detection and identification of the health needs of the various groups of the population, as well as for the control and surveillance of infectious diseases and dealing with extraordinary risks and unforeseen special circumstances.

The Epidemiological Surveillance and Control of Infectious Diseases Unit (EMC&EC) of the Ministry of Health and Welfare, within the framework of epidemiological surveillance, is responsible for the continuous and systematic monitoring, identification and recording of compulsorily notifiable diseases as well as their prevention and limitation in those controlled by the Republic of Cyprus areas with targeted interventions. It also has the responsibility for the timely identification of new and emerging infectious diseases that appear in our country and the quick preparation and immediate response to these diseases. Each country's infectious disease surveillance systems play a vital role in protecting public health as they can quickly and promptly identify potential threats to the health of the population. They therefore help the MEE&ELN to respond, implementing flexible and timely measures or even programs, which are adjusted or reviewed on a continuous basis through monitoring their effectiveness.

The role of the MEE&ELN in dealing with epidemics or other catastrophic events related to infectious diseases such as the COVID-19 pandemic, influenza epidemics and the recent outbreak of monkeypox is also important. It is also responsible for the development and implementation of Action Plans to deal with epidemics caused by specific infectious causes.

Epidemiological data are analysed, evaluated and used to take action in cases of emergency epidemiological crises such as an epidemic or a pandemic, as they help to understand the nature of the disease and the needs of the affected population. Although epidemics are by their nature unpredictable, a proper and organized surveillance system helps every country to be properly prepared and have the right planning and resources to better manage the crisis.

MEE&ELN collaborates with international organizations, such as the World Health Organization (WHO) and the European Center for Disease Prevention and Control (ECDC) for coordination in relation to the treatment of old and newly emerging infectious diseases, especially in cases involving the risk of spreading to other countries. At the same time, the MEE&ELN is responsible for Public Health issues of International Interest based on the International Health Regulations (International Health Regulation-IHR) at the entry points of the Republic of Cyprus, such as ports and airports, to prevent the entry and spread of infectious diseases on the island.

At the same time, the IY&YDY contribute actively and substantially together with the other Departments of the Ministry of Health in the management of crises and threats to the health of citizens and in the drafting of protocols and guidelines.

The Scholarly Service plays an important role by promoting targeted programs related to equal promotion and maintenance of the health and well-being of students of all levels of education in the public and private sector and the prevention of diseases within the school premises. The emerging needs, especially after the reforms in the Cyprus Health System, but especially after the COVID-19 pandemic that affected

the health sector of the child population, made it imperative to upgrade the organization and the way the School Medical Service operates. As a result, the Department of Health and Human Services and the Cyprus University of Technology (TEPAK) have entered into a cooperation agreement on April 28, 2023 for the preparation of a 12-month study for the restructuring of the Scholarly Service.

At the same time, the Academic Service, in the context of the promotion of digital health, has created the student's electronic file and it is expected to be implemented after securing an electronic storage space for the data and approval by the Personal Data Protection Commissioner. The student's electronic file will help in easy access to the collected data, in the early detection of vulnerable groups of students, in the assessment of the level of vaccination coverage of students and in matters of research and statistics at local and European level.

The OH&YDY in collaboration with the Asylum Service proceeded to upgrade the public health services provided at the First Reception Center (KEPY) Pournara. In order to optimize the management of the various incidents, it carries out for all immigrants without exception, the necessary diagnostic tests required by the protocols, as well as treatments where and where deemed necessary, before they are allowed to leave the Center. It is noted that Cyprus today is perhaps the most important gateway for immigrants and asylum seekers, given its size and population, compared to the other main countries of entry (Italy, Greece). This fact has significantly increased the need to provide health services related to Public Health on behalf of the IY&YDY.

In order to develop programs in the field of Health and Environment, the I.Y.&Y.D.Y. participate in working groups/committees both at the European Union (EU) and national level. In addition, the Health and Medical Services have the responsibility for carrying out all the Medical Councils of the public and wider public sector, as well as for the issuance of various Health Certificates either based on legislation/regulations or following relevant decisions. In this context, a record was made of the categories of Medical Councils that are carried out, and completed a manual with best practices to be adopted, in order to improve the processes.

The strengthening of the participation of I.Y.&Y.D.Y in Working Groups and Committees of European and International Organizations and the participation in European/Research co-financed projects, with the aim of exchanging expertise and continuously improving the quality of existing health services, remain among in the main activities of the Department.

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Surveillance, early detection and control of infectious diseases

The Epidemiological Surveillance and Control of Infectious Diseases Unit carries out Surveillance and Control of Infectious Diseases, early detection and response to epidemics, preparation for dealing with threats from infectious diseases, whether they occur locally or cross-border.

Its actions concern:

1. In Epidemiological surveillance/monitoring/detection of serious infectious diseases in the territory. The resulting data are analyzed by the Unit to draw conclusions and formulate policy, regarding the prevention and immediate response to these diseases.
2. In laboratory epidemiological surveillance and laboratory preparedness for diagnosis of infectious diseases.

3. In the early detection of new and emerging infectious diseases that appear in our country and in quick preparation and immediate response to these diseases.
4. In dealing with epidemics or other catastrophic events related to infectious diseases such as it's the flu and the COVID-19 pandemic.
5. In the development, updating and implementation of Action Plans for dealing with epidemics from specific infectious causes and in the general increase of the preparedness of the country. In cases of emergency, the Unit is responsible for communicating both with the public and with health professionals (public and private sector), as well as with other governmental and non-governmental services, in order to coordinate its response.
6. To evaluate and strengthen our national vaccination programs. Collection of data to estimate vaccination coverage in population groups is imperative. Today it is done by carrying out time-consuming research. After the implementation of the NHS, the goal of the MEE&ELN in collaboration with the Health Insurance Organization is to collect vaccination data from the registrations of Personal Physicians in the NHS information system.
7. To cooperate on a systematic basis with international organizations, such as the World Health Organization and the European Center for Disease Control (ECDC) for coordination in relation to the treatment of old and newly emerging infectious diseases and pandemics, especially if they involve a risk of spreading to other countries for cross-border Health threats. The MEE&ELN, with its participation and representation in Institutional Bodies of the European Union as well as in International bodies, is informed in a timely manner about Public Health matters, while at the same time it participates in the European surveillance system and in decision-making on Public Health matters. This action has been essential in the management of the COVID-19 pandemic so far and is expected to continue further in the course of the pandemic within 2022 and for as long as it lasts.
8. Treatment of antimicrobial resistance and nosocomial infections. Development and implementation of a National Plan Action to combat antimicrobial resistance (AMR).
9. Implementation of the National Strategies for the prevention of HIV and the eradication of Hepatitis C in Cyprus. It is important to achieve the revised goals set by the joint United Nations program on HIV and AIDS, with a time horizon for implementation in 2030. In this context, we aim to diagnose 95% of all HIV-positive people, provide antiretroviral treatment (ART) in 95% of those diagnosed and achieving viral suppression in 95% of those treated. At the same time, for the treatment of HIV and Hepatitis, enlightenment and prevention actions are carried out as well as actions to ensure universal and unhindered access to medical and pharmaceutical care.
10. Implementation of the National Strategy to deal with Tuberculosis. The Ministry of Health invests in the prevention, early diagnosis and effective treatment of tuberculosis. At the same time, immediacy is important investigation of the incidents following their declaration to limit possible transmission. The objectives of the actions are the control of the increased rate of positivity among immigrants, as well as the general reduction of the incidence of tuberculosis in our country.
11. Public Health Issues at the First Reception Center for asylum seekers, where the MEE&ELN has a coordinating role in the management of incidents involving infectious diseases (e.g. tuberculosis). In collaboration with a multidisciplinary team at KEPY Pournara, data of interest to Public Health is obtained (previous vaccinations, infections, etc.), while at the same time examinations for various infectious diseases are carried out/recorded. These data are evaluated by the MEE&ELN in the context of epidemiological surveillance.

The main objectives of the MEE&ELN are to improve the various surveillance systems with actions such as their digitization, the increase of the data collected and their quality, the improvement of the analysis of epidemiological data and epidemiological reports as well as the treatment of their underreporting.

The work of the MEE&ELN is expected to be strengthened by the project implemented by the Department of Health and Human Services in the Recovery and Resilience Plan for the period 2021-2026 (Digital Public Health Platform (CIPHIS, Cyprus Innovative Public Health information and communications technology (ICT) System), with a budget €5.7m which concerns:

- a) Creation of tools for epidemiological surveillance of the influenza virus and the new coronavirus according to WHO and ECDC guidelines: •
Influenza surveillance with Sentinel;
• Laboratory surveillance of influenza and novel coronavirus and •
Surveillance of serious cases of acute respiratory infection and deaths in hospitals.
- b) Digitization of the declaration process of Compulsorily Notifiable Diseases.
- c) Creation of a central Server for the purposes of the above tools as well as the development of a Website for the purpose of informing Citizens and Health Professionals about the various Public Health issues.

At the same time, MEE&ELN, focusing on the improvement of surveillance systems, participates or has expressed an interest in participating in the following financed/co-financed actions:

- a) Design and implementation of multinational surveillance systems using routinely collected electronic health records in EU/EEA: Electronic Health Record-based SARI surveillance project. The aim of EHR-SARI is to support EU/EEA countries in the piloting, implementation and evaluation of surveillance systems for SARI using Electronic Health Records.
- b) EU4H-2023-JA-02: Direct grants to Member States' authorities: to enhance, extend and consolidate wastewater surveillance for public health (HERA) (CP-g-23-18) -EU-WISH. The focus of this joint action, (EU-WISH), is to support activities to strengthen, expand and consolidate wastewater surveillance for Public Health. EU-WISH will improve national capacities for public health wastewater surveillance by enhancing knowledge sharing and exchange of best practices based on scientific evidence. c) EU4H-2023-DGA-MS-IBA-01: Direct grants to Member States' authorities: improving and strengthening national surveillance systems (Regulation of the European Parliament and of the Council on serious cross-border threats to health and repealing Decision No 1082/2013/EV) (CP-g-23-01). The aim of the action is to support Member States to improve their surveillance systems by developing their interoperability and reliability by making use of available health data.

Antimicrobial resistance is a growing threat to global health. The EU's approach to tackling the problem is 'One Health', which addresses issues in the areas of human health, animal health and the environment. To improve our country's response to antimicrobial resistance, MEE&ELN has developed various actions for better monitoring, the prudent use of antimicrobial substances, as well as strengthening Public Health strategies. It is noted that in 2023 the following newly established National Committees were operational:

- a) National One Health Committee for Combating Antimicrobial Resistance. The committee in question consists of representatives of all involved bodies and has an advisory role to the Ministers of Health and Agriculture, Rural Development and Environment and plans/coordinates actions to deal with Antimicrobial Resistance
- b) Central Committee for the Control and Monitoring of Nosocomial Infections. The purpose of the committee in question is to plan and supervise the implementation of the policy for the control and prevention of infections in health care facilities.

In addition, the subcommittee members of the first committee called the Antibiotics Advisory Committee of the Ministry of Health have been appointed which is expected to meet for the first time soon. This subcommittee will deal with issues of dealing with Microbial Resistance in the Medical Sector.

Participation of the Department in the following financed/co-financed actions:

- a) Design of an Electronic platform for the surveillance of Nosocomial Antibiotic Consumption and Healthcare – Associated Infections. The project aims to create an electronic platform through which the consumption of antibiotics in hospitals and hospital infections will be monitored and

is funded by the EU's Recovery and Resilience Mechanism. The total funding amounts to €400,000 and the project is expected to be completed by the end of 2025.

- b) Joint Action on AMR and HAI (EU-JAMRAI): Joint action of the European Union on antimicrobial resistance (AMR) and hospital-acquired infections. EU-JAMRAI's mission is to encourage synergies between EU Member States by developing and implementing effective One Health Approach policies to combat the growing threat of AMR and to reduce hospital-acquired infections .

ACTIVITY 2: Health promotion and upgrading of the health care services provided

It includes actions to prevent mortality and morbidity with a focus on high-risk groups. Prevention of the effects of diseases such as obesity, diabetes, epilepsy, allergic disorders, etc. In this context, the National Committee for the Quality of Life of the Population through Healthy Diet and Exercise was established. Its responsibility is the preparation of the National Strategy with the aim of promoting healthy eating and physical exercise. This Committee is expected to record the strategy for the issue of Quality of Life and Exercise.

In addition, in the context of the operation of the commentary service, the following actions are underway:

- Health promotion and early detection and treatment of infectious diseases in the school environment in accordance with the applicable protocols of the Ministry of Health and in cooperation with the Health Visitors
- Supervisory control of detection programs, schedule determination, and frequency of detection exams according to international scientific data
- Supervisory control of vaccination coverage of children and referring them to personal doctors/pediatricians or to vaccination centers, in cases where vaccines are lacking, according to their age. Vaccinations against covid-19 in schools.
- Advisory role to the Ministry of Education on Public Health issues, management of children with issues of delinquency, violence/abuse, addiction, eating disorders, learning difficulties, in collaboration with the Social Welfare Services
- Participation in multi-disciplinary groups KEPO (Central Provincial Multi-Thematic Groups) and EPO (District Multi-Thematic Groups) for children where the sponsor is the state and need multi-disciplinary treatment
- Control of children from trapped families
- Medical coverage for school matches
- Participation in Health Education in schools (educational material and lectures) in collaboration with Health visitors and the Ministry of Health
- Informative lectures and training for teachers and parents, on handling and dealing with students with chronic health problems in the school environment (diabetes, anaphylaxis, epilepsy, etc.), pandemic issues
- Informative lectures for teachers and parents on issues related to children's health
- Preparation of health protocols for the management of infectious disease incidents such as Covid-19, streptococcus, tuberculosis, coxsackie virus, scabies, staph, etc. in schools and nurseries.
- Problem management for students coming from third countries (refugees, economic migrants) with different cultural, religious and linguistic backgrounds, who most of the time are not beneficiaries of GeSY
- Health education on topics related to sexual education, adolescence, personal hygiene, accident prevention, nutrition, smoking, pandemic, environmental health, organ donation and transplantation • Extension of the Scholarly Service to private schools.

- Extension of the visual acuity detection program to children aged 15.

At the same time, the Health & Health Department participates in the work, within the KEPY Pournara, of a Medical Multidisciplinary Team which consists of Doctors of Health & Health, Health Visitors of the Directorate of Nursing Services of the Health and Health Center and Nurses of the OKYpY to evaluate the health of newly entered irregular immigrants. The aim is to safeguard Public Health and safeguard the health of immigrants. The main actions of the Department relate to: •

Determination

of the quarantine period where it is applied

- Obtain a medical history and complete an Immigrant Health Assessment Report
- Carrying out vaccinations
- Carrying out laboratory tests
- Perform Mantoux test
- Referral for examinations by medical specialists
- Issuance of a certificate of completion of required public health examinations, which is delivered to the Service Asylum for the release of residents of KEPY Pournara.

ACTIVITY 3: Development of environmental health policy

The main actions for Environmental Health Development include:

- Informing and raising awareness of the population about the adverse effects on their health from the negative and harmful factors of the environment. The ultimate goal is to reduce the population's exposure to harmful environmental factors, especially when these factors are documented to be particularly elevated. • Promote measures to reduce and eliminate negative health effects related to environmental factors:
 - Implementation of policy in relation to airborne particles (eg Dust - Today the phenomenon of dust is a matter of concern at European level and Cyprus, Crete and Israel are estimated to be in the area with the highest percentages of dust in Europe).
 - Determining health effects from exposure to chemicals (fumes), atmospheric emissions (Oil-gas stations, central heating burners) as well as from contact/use of objects releasing free radicals such as plastic cups, straws, etc. With regard to petrol stations, a study is planned to determine the factors that are important to investigate from a Public Health point of view, with the aim of revising the OSH policy. Protection from ionizing and non-ionizing radiation.
- Dealing with extreme weather conditions e.g. heat.
- Utilization of aid from the European Environment Agency (EEA) of the European Union. It is pointed out that the EOP provides the Policy makers and the public with the correct (Valid – Targeted – Independent) information regarding the Environment.

ACTIVITY 4: Medical Advice and Issuance of Health Certificates

The Health & Medical Director has a legal obligation to set up Medical Councils (MCUs) to examine referrals from Departments/ Services of the Public and Wider Public Sector regarding:

- IS of the Educational Service
- Public and Wider Public Sector (EPS) including Local Government Authorities (LAGs)
- Civil Defense IS
- The Applicants for Political Asylum
- IS requested by the Department of Road Transport
- IS of Labor / Hourly Staff

- IS of the Army / National Guard
- IS Police
- Department of Prisons
- IS requested by the Legal Service of the Republic

Also, due to a legal obligation arising from relevant legislation or regulations, it is mandatory for the Health & Safety Director to issue Health Certificates for food handlers, foreign students, professional driver's license, private motor vehicle driver's license, police officers, adoption, asylum seekers, persons who are appointed to the Public and Educational Service (upon recruitment), carers of children and nursing homes, lifeguards, athletes, etc. In support of these actions, the creation of an electronic platform for the registration of Medical Council data and health certificates is being promoted.

OBJECTIVE 2: IMPROVE THE EFFECTIVENESS OF SUPERVISORY / SELECTIVE GUIDANCE MECHANISMS IN THE FIELD OF PUBLIC HEALTH

1. EXISTING CONDITION

The Health Services of the Health & Safety Department, in collaboration with all interested parties, develop a single and comprehensive policy for food safety and environmental hygiene, based on the constantly evolving EU regulatory framework and the data resulting from the analysis of potential risks in scientific basis. They take into account technological development, continuous surveillance of the entire food chain and the development of new control methods.

According to the existing regime, their responsibilities are divided into the following areas:

a) Food control (safety and quality and food business control)

The Health Services have the authority to exercise official controls at all stages of the food chain of food of non-animal origin, including honey and ice creams. Their responsibilities do not include the primary production of food of plant origin. In addition, they are responsible for checks at the retail level of food of animal origin, except for fresh and frozen meat. Official controls aim to implement the provisions of Community food law. In addition to Community Legislation, they also apply National Legislation, as harmonized.

To implement and control harmonized legislation, in cooperation with all interested parties, they develop a single and comprehensive policy to ensure food safety. This policy is based on the data presented on the one hand by the accession of Cyprus to the EU. and on the other hand by the continuous development of the food industry worldwide related to the use of new technologies for the production, processing and preservation of food and the adoption of new control methods by the competent authorities.

b) Prevention/investigation of outbreaks of infectious diseases

The Health Services, as part of their strategy, conduct programs to ensure the safety of food and water and thus contribute to the prevention of the transmission of foodborne and waterborne diseases.

c) Public environmental hygiene

The Health Services within the framework of their responsibilities arising from the applicable Community and National legislation intervene preventively mainly in the various fields of human activity. The field of Environmental Health covers a wide range of activities where the Health Services in collaboration with other involved Services are responsible for monitoring and taking measures.

In order to achieve the above objectives, the Health Service relies on the quality of its human resources, which makes continuous efforts to meet the ever-increasing needs of its mission.

In addition to the above, the Health Services participate in the management of pandemics and emergencies, as was the case with the covid-19 pandemic. In particular, they contributed to the conduct and coordination of the controls for the measures both in properties that were previously under the responsibility of the Service and in other areas. In addition, they undertook the writing of the protocols with the measures for the operation of various economic sectors, the imposition of measures (suspension of operation, disinfection control) on properties where positive cases were found, interpretation of the provisions of the Decrees and answers to questions from the public, explanation to the public about matters of the measures, disinfection of public buildings, examination and approval of various requests of citizens to hold events.

The **Competent Authority for Medical Technological Equipment** is the regulatory authority whose purpose is the supervisory control of both the medical technological products available within the Cypriot market, as well as the local economic entities that are active in the manufacture, certification and distribution of these products. The Authority, based on the high level of protection of the health of patients and users, objectively applies the provisions of local and European legislation on medical technological equipment, in order to ensure as best as possible access to fully compliant and safe medical technological products. The Director of the I.Y&Y.D.Y Department is designated as the Competent Authority.

At the same time, the Medical Technological Equipment Subsidy Plan for Hospitals has been included in the Recovery and Resilience Plan for the period 2021-2026, through which the strengthening of competitiveness and the upgrading of health services is sought. The main objective of the Plan is to improve the quality and type of health services provided.

Currently, in the Republic of Cyprus, 77 private hospitals operate. The Director of the I.Y&Y.D.Y is the Superintendent of Private Hospitals. The **Superintendent and Inspectors of Private Hospitals** are competent and responsible for monitoring the continued compliance of Private Hospitals with the provisions of the Private Hospitals (Control of Establishment and Operation) Act 2001 until 2022. The team of Inspectors of Private Hospitals consists of one (1) medical officer and four (4) nursing officers.

Also, the Plan for the Provision of Government Grants to Private Hospitals for the Purpose of Accreditation has been included in the Recovery and Resilience Plan for the period 2021-2026, which aims to provide incentives for upgrading the quality of health services provided through the application of standards and accreditation their.

The **clinical laboratories** operate according to the license of the Ministry of Health and their operation depends on the "Registration and Operation of Clinical Laboratories Law" N.132/88. It is expected that with the implementation of a modern legislation, with the passing of the bill that is before the House of Representatives, the following procedures will be updated, thus strengthening the supervision, control, supporting education, training and accreditation of the clinical laboratories. About 150 Clinical Laboratories are currently operating in the Republic of Cyprus. Accreditation of all laboratories is strongly encouraged and promoted by the Superintendent and Inspectors of Clinical Laboratories of the Ministry of Health, with the aim of improving the quality of services offered to patients. So far 126 Laboratories have been accredited with ISO 15189. Four Inspectors have been appointed in accordance with the Law and 59 inspections have been carried out for 2021.

Blood Banks operate in accordance with the Blood Donation Law 58(I)/1997, where the Competent Authority is the Director of Medical Services and in accordance with the relevant European Directives (DIRECTIVE 2002/98/EC, DIRECTIVE 2004/33/EC, DIRECTIVE 2005/61/EC, DIRECTIVE 2005/62/EC). All Blood Banks are a network of accredited laboratories according to ISO 15189. Two Blood Banks operate in Nicosia and one in all other cities. They serve the needs of patients in blood derivatives throughout Cyprus and carry out specialized immunohaematological tests to promote safe transfusion.

In addition, IY&YDY promotes:

- a) Bill for the operation, control and supervision of radiodiagnostic centers (the first has been prepared draft),
- b) Bill for the provision of Palliative Care (a first draft is expected to be delivered to authorities September 2023) and
- c) Bill for the operation, control and supervision of radiodiagnostic centers.

At the same time, with the aim of improving the quality of the services provided, IY&YDY promotes:

- a) the accreditation of inspectors of private hospitals, the competent medical technology authority equipment and clinical laboratories with CYS EN ISO/IEC 17020:2012 and
- b) the creation of an IT system to record and assist the inspectors' work

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Food safety and quality assurance and control of infectious diseases associated with food, water and medical insects and smoking control

Health Services are responsible for ensuring the safety and quality of food through official food and premises controls, which include inspection, approval, sampling, complaint investigation, import controls, of food produced in areas outside the effective control of the Government of the Republic of Cyprus during its transit to the areas where the Republic exercises effective control, enforcement measures and informing the public and those responsible for food businesses.

In addition, they have responsibility for the control of infectious diseases associated with food, water and insects of medical importance, as well as control for the implementation of smoking legislation.

The main actions are the following:

- Defining policy and drawing up control plans for processed foods of non-animal origin (including ice cream), honey and compound foods at all levels, as well as for food of animal origin at the retail level.
- Ensuring food safety and quality achieved through official food and premises controls, including inspection, approval, sampling, investigation of complaints, import controls, enforcement and public information and food business managers.
- Effective use of the various EU systems for information exchange, ie RASFF, Food Fraud Network, TRACESNT
- Environmental Sanitation achieved through: (a) the investigation of foodborne and waterborne infectious diseases, (b) monitoring and control of water and bathing waters, (c) mosquito control programs, (d) awareness of the public on matters of environmental hygiene, (e) the application of smoking legislation and (f) the investigation of complaints related to nuisances (insects of medical importance, rodents, etc.).

ACTIVITY 2: Safety management of medical devices

The Competent Authority for Medical Technological Equipment has as its mission the protection of Public Health in relation to the circulation of medical technological products in Cyprus.

Its main actions concern:

- Configuration of Regulatory Framework and Communication-Cooperation with other Agencies.
- Registration/Registration of Economic Bodies, Classification of medical technology products and its assessment their compliance.
- Supervision after the medical technology products are placed on the market.
- Definition and supervision of Notified Bodies.
- Clinical evaluation and performance evaluation.

- Medical devices manufactured with tissues of animal origin.

The Competent Authority has undertaken the implementation of a Plan in the Recovery and Resilience Plan for the period 2021-2026 for the Subsidy of Medical Technological Equipment for Hospitals. The total amount that will be allocated for the needs of the Plan, which is implemented within the framework of Measure C1.1I3 of the SAA, during its implementation period amounts to €5,000,000. The plan aims to provide financial incentives, in the form of government sponsorship to Hospitals, for the replacement or purchase of new medical technological equipment, with an emphasis on the purchase of high or digital technology.

ACTIVITY 3: Effective supervision of health providers

Supervision of private hospitals:

The activities of the mandated Inspectors of Private Hospitals concern the control and supervision of the establishment and operation of private hospitals in accordance with the Private Hospitals (Establishment and Operation Control) Laws of 2001 until 2022.

The main actions are the following:

- Carrying out annual and extraordinary audits in licensed private hospitals, in order to establish whether they comply with the requirements of this Law and the Regulations and comply with the various conditions of their license.
- Investigation of complaints/incidents related to matters concerning private hospitals in function with the referenced Law.
- Licensing of Private Hospitals in accordance with the mentioned Laws (examination of applications for the issuance of Establishment and Operation licenses).
- Implementation of a plan to provide Government Grants to Private Hospitals for the purpose of their Accreditation. The project has been included in the Recovery and Resilience Plan for the period 2021-2026 with a total budget of €2,500,000.

Supervision of Clinical

Laboratories: The Superintendent and Inspectors of Clinical Laboratories of the Ministry of Health ensure in accordance with the applicable legislation

the following: • Licensing in accordance with the Laws and regulations of Clinical Laboratories.

- Continuous control, monitoring and evaluation of approved Clinical Laboratories.
- Ensuring quality and quality performance by promoting the introduction of quality standards.
- Development of guidelines.
- Training of biomedical scientists.

ACTIVITY 4: Management of blood and its derivatives

The mission of the Blood Bank Service is to promote the safety of transfusions and the optimal management of blood derivatives stocks in Cyprus

The main actions of the service are:

- The promotion of technology in the field of transfusions.
- The information and cooperation of the clinical area for everything related to the practice of transfusions.
- Monitoring the needs for blood products.
- Informing the Blood Center, which is under the Central Administration of the Ministry of Health, about the current needs.
- The recording of adverse reactions and events related to the transfusion.
- The continuous education and training of the staff.
- The implementation of a quality system for all activities and services related to transfusion offered by the Blood Bank Service.

PERFORMANCE AND PERFORMANCE INDICATORS - MEDICAL AND PUBLIC SERVICES HEALTH

Objective (S) / Activity (D)	Performance Index (S) / Performance (D)	Index Results - 2021	Description
S1: Promotion and safeguarding of public health, disease prevention and improvement of citizens' quality of life	ŸE1: Morbidity rate and Mortality rate		
D01: Surveillance, early detection and control of infectious diseases	DA01: Vaccination coverage rate of the population Frequency of occurrence of new cases of infectious diseases as defined in the relevant legislation		$\frac{\text{number of children vaccinated for coverage of childhood illnesses} \times 100}{\text{total number of children}}$ $\frac{\text{number of new cases infectious diseases}}{\text{total population}}$
D02: Promoting Health and Improving its Accessibility All of it Population in Health Services	DA02: Percentage of school-age children served by the School Medicine Service Average rates of achievement of specified actions Percentage of beneficiaries (served by the services) of people who belong to the vulnerable population groups		$\frac{\text{number of school-age children who are served} \times 100}{\text{total number of school age children}}$ This indicator is the average of the percentages of achievement of the defined objectives based on the actions $\frac{\text{Number of persons belonging to category of vulnerable groups which benefits from Health Services}}{\text{total number of people in the category of the vulnerable group they belong to}}$ The following were selected: 1. KYFAM Immigrants, 2. a specific group of substance addicts, 3. victims of domestic violence residing in SPAVO Hostels and

			4. the Prisoners.
<u>D03:</u> Development of environmental health policy	<u>DA03:</u> Average rates of achievement of specified actions		This indicator is the average of the percentages of achievement of the goals they determine based on the actions
<u>D04:</u> Medical Advice and Issuance of Health Certificates	<u>DA04:</u> Reference review response time Total Health Certificates issued by category		Average referral review time Number of Health Certificates issued by category
<u>S02:</u> Improving efficiency of supervisory/selective guidance mechanisms in the field of Public Health	<u>DE02:</u> Non-conformance rate		$\frac{\text{number of Non-Compliances}}{\text{total number of Recommendations to Compliance}}$
<u>D05:</u> Ensuring food safety and quality and controlling infectious diseases associated with food, water and insects of medical importance and control of smoking	<u>DA05:</u> Average percentage of achievement of targets set according to the ISO System 9001 applied by the Health Services		This indicator is the average of the percentages of achievement of the measurable objectives determined on an annual basis by the Health Services based on the ISO 9001 Quality Management System that cover Food Safety and Environmental Hygiene
<u>D06:</u> Medical device safety management	<u>DA06:</u> Rate of Completion of Regulatory Obligations of the Competent Authority of Medical Technological Equipment		The indicator is a quantitative assessment of the achievement of the legal obligations of the regulatory authority for medical devices and which are reflected in the pre-defined actions of the Competent Authority for Medical Devices

<u>D06.1:</u> Effective supervision of private hospitals	<u>DA06.1:</u> Percentage of private hospitals inspected at least twice		$\frac{\text{number of private hospitals that inspected at least twice} + X 100}{\text{total number of private hospitals}}$
<u>D06.2:</u> Effective supervision of clinical laboratories	<u>DA06.2:</u> Percentage of clinical laboratories inspected on an annual basis		$\frac{\text{number of clinical laboratories that inspected} \times 100}{\text{total number of clinical laboratories}}$
<u>IO6.3</u> Promotion of scientific training of Biomedical Scientists	<u>DA06.3</u> Organization of Conference on Biomedical Sciences		$\frac{\text{Participation of Clinical Laboratories} \times 100}{\text{Total number of Clinical Laboratories}}$
<u>D06:</u> Blood Bank Service and Blood Vigilance	<u>DA06:</u> Rate of use of blood by Clinics Adverse event rate/respond of Derivatives disposition response time		$\frac{\text{number of units used}}{\text{the e a}}$ $\frac{\text{number of events/reactions}}{\text{number of units transfused}}$ The time from the ordering of blood derivatives to the time of processing all required tests for the patient and making the derivatives available is a service performance indicator, according to the ISO 15189 quality standard.

GRAPHIC SUMMARY 2024 - MEDICAL AND PUBLIC HEALTH SERVICES

DEPARTMENT: MENTAL HEALTH SERVICES

All Services have been transferred to the National Health Services Agency.

All personnel costs are included in activity 98.

DEPARTMENT: DENTAL SERVICES

GOAL 1: ENSURING A HIGH LEVEL OF ORAL HEALTH AND SUPPLY DENTAL CARE

1. EXISTING CONDITION

Dental Services (DST) are divided into two areas, preventive and therapeutic. At the same time, support groups have been created under the Directorate of Dental Services that deal with issues of strategic planning, budgeting, offers, human resource management and monitoring and participation in European co-financed programs.

In total, the OUs have a network of 42 dental clinics/dental offices all over Cyprus which are housed in seven (7) hospitals, eight (8) urban health centers, two (2) institutions and twelve (12) rural health centers that offer primary, secondary and tertiary dental care. At the same time, they have 4 mobile dental units

Primary dental care includes preventive actions, secondary conservative dental treatment and tertiary specialized treatment of complex periodontal, pediatric and endodontic cases as well as minor oral surgery and restorative prosthetic restoration with removable prosthetic work

In detail, the actions of the therapeutic sector include the following:

(A) Provision of high level dental services in hospitals, urban and rural health centers throughout Cyprus, both for inpatients and outpatients.

(B) Treatment of dental emergencies on a 24-hour basis in the First Aid departments of the General Hospitals of Nicosia, Limassol, Larnaca and Paphos.

(C) Dealing with complicated and specialized cases after referral to the Periodontology, Paedodontics, and Endodontics Clinics at the Nicosia General Hospital.

(D) Fabrication of partial and complete dentures (acrylic and metal) by the Prosthetic Clinics and the dental laboratories operating in the Nicosia Hospitals, Larnaca Old Hospital, Limassol Old Hospital and Paphos Hospital. (E) Addressing incidents involving problems in the Temporomandibular

Joint through the manufacture of splints initially in a pilot phase by the prosthetic clinic of the Nicosia General Hospital in collaboration with the corresponding dental laboratory and gradually manufactured by all prosthetic clinics and dental laboratories throughout Cyprus

(F) Case management of Minor Oral Surgery throughout Cyprus. (G)

Treatment of orthodontic cases of children up to 18 years of age who meet specific financial and functional criteria. (H) Treatment of children and

adults with special abilities under general anesthesia at the Nicosia General Hospital by the Pediatric Dentistry Clinic in collaboration with the Oral and Maxillofacial Surgery Clinic.

(I) In the context of social policy, dental clinics operate in the Penitentiary institution of the Prisons as well as in the Christos Stelios Ioannou institution.

Since March 2021, the Dental Services have contracted with the OAU providing the range of preventive dental care reimbursed by the NHS. The related compensation is expected to increase the revenues of the Department. During 2022, revenues of €59,634.61 were recorded compared to €72,718 in 2021.

In 2021, there were 44,511 visits to the Dental Services, while in 2022 they reached 44,981. In 2021, 548 operations were performed with local anesthesia, a number that increased to 601 cases in 2022. In relation to cases treated with general anesthesia, these amounted to 44 in 2022 compared to 16 in 2021.

The actions of the preventive sector include the following:

A) Informative lectures for children, parents and various organized groups on oral health. Preparation and publication of informative material and audio-visual media in collaboration with the Press and Information Office.

B) Programs for the early detection of caries in all children aged 5 and 6 years (pre-primary and first grade of primary school). From 2016-17, all 6-year-old children attending private schools were included in the program schools while at the same time it expanded to include 27% of the 15-year-old students of the 3rd grade of high school.

C) Free provision of preventive and therapeutic treatment to children aged 6-12 years through the 4 mobile dental units available to the Dental Services. Due to the restrictive measures, the program of mobile dental units in 2021 and 2022 was temporarily suspended. The resumption is estimated to take place from the school year 2023-24 after the special sterilization furnaces will have been installed.

D) Cooperation program with the private sector and free dental care for all 11-year-old students (Eth grade of public and private schools), with costs covered by the OU (8,000 children).

E) Information campaigns on issues related to oral health and diseases of the oral cavity (eg oral cancer, world oral health day).

F) Elaboration of epidemiological and other research with the aim, among others: i) updating the epidemiological map of Cyprus, ii) recording the knowledge, attitudes and perceptions of the citizens of Cyprus in matters of oral health and hygiene, visits to the dentist and knowledge regarding oral diseases and iii) the consequences of the pandemic on the dental profession in Cyprus.

The promotion of oral health and the prevention of dental diseases continue to be the main axes of the strategy of the Dental Services.

In view of the adoption of Resolution 74.5 (WHA 74.5 Resolution on Oral Health) on oral health at last year's World Health Organization Session, which concerns the draft of the Global Oral Health Strategy, the Dental Services of the Ministry of Health they intend to prepare a Plan of Action for Oral Health with the aim of formulating an Oral Health Strategy under its auspices Ministry of Health. The goal is the implementation of policies that will highlight the importance of oral health and its integration into actions related to the prevention and treatment of chronic diseases.

The Department, on an annual basis, processes statistical data concerning the number of visits to the OU, the patient profile, the number of new patients and the type of work offered.

Participates in the Council of European Chief Dental Officers (CECDO) which has an advisory advisory role in oral health policy-making.

With the help of the EU co-funded scheme for determining the age of asylum seekers who claim to be minors, it provides important work to the Asylum Service.

At the same time, it has the responsibility of controlling the coverage of expenses for the purchase of dental services for civil servants working abroad. The Ministry of Health received for 2022, 198 requests from civil servants working in the Embassies of the Republic and have received the required approval for a total of €74,512 in dental care that falls under the provisions of the Government and Medical Institutions and Services General Regulations of 2013 .

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Provision of high quality dental services in hospitals, urban and rural health centers and other institutions (incl. Central Prisons, Stelios Ioannou Foundation)

The wide range of dental care will continue to be offered to all eligible patients.

In order to achieve an increase in the degree of satisfaction of patients who visit OUs, a number of actions are continuously promoted with the aim of ensuring the high level of quality of the services offered and improving the access and use of dental services. These actions are the following:

- i. Planning improvement projects in health centers where dental clinics are housed, so that staff work in comfortable and ergonomic spaces that have the necessary storage spaces and are friendly and accessible to patients. ii. Identification and satisfaction of the logistical equipment needs of OUs (dental machines, modern sterilization ovens, x-ray machines, other devices, dental tools and materials), so as to achieve the provision of effective and efficient dental care.
- iii. Training and development of human resources, with the preparation of a learning plan in collaboration with the Cyprus Academy of Public Administration for the organization of educational programs in accordance with the strategic goals and needs that emerged from the diagnosis of learning needs. Programming of educational days and workshops on specialized dental topics with professors from the Dental Schools of Athens Thessaloniki and the European University of Cyprus. At the same time, postgraduate trainings are planned in the form of granting small scholarships, dental officers at the Dental Schools of Athens and Thessaloniki in specialized fields of dentistry or attending specialized conferences.
- iv. Continuous monitoring of the implementation of the institution of the predetermined time (appointment) for visiting dental offices, which has been applied universally with the aim of not creating long waiting lists. Improving the referral process in specialized dental clinics by defining specific procedures and criteria. Use of digital technology to inform citizens/remind appointments.
- v. Creation of a Geriatrics Clinic at the Nicosia General Hospital which will function as a Referral Center for elderly patients as well as patients with chronic diseases whose dental treatment needs treatment in a hospital setting. The referral system will be based on specific scientific criteria.
- vi. Creation of new dental clinics in health centers (Geroskipou) and hospitals.
- vii. Continuous staff training in dealing with cases with Temporomandibular problems Articulation (KGA) through the manufacture of splints. The manufacture of splints has been piloted in the prosthetic clinic of the Nicosia district and will gradually be extended to all prosthetic clinics throughout Cyprus.
- viii. Strengthening the procurement and procurement unit in the OUs by training other members of the OU staff who will be responsible for the following: preparation of tenders for the purchase of equipment, tools and consumables, announcement of tenders, evaluation of tenders, receipt of equipment, consumables, storage , maintaining warehouse stock control and billing system software in dental practices throughout Cyprus.
- ix. Implementation of the Memorandum of Cooperation signed with the Dental School of the European University for the service of patients, the training of dentists and the development of research of mutual interest.

ACTIVITY 2: Policy for the management of the fund that concerns the coverage of costs for the purchase of dental services by civil servants working in the Embassies of the Republic abroad.

The number of requests received in 2022 from civil servants working in the Embassies of the Republic to cover the cost of dental care needed during their stay abroad amounted to 198. According to the calculations to date, in 2022 a total of expenditure amounting to €74512 to cover these requests.

The requests are checked by an Authorized Dental Officer of the OU whether the type of dental treatment for which coverage of the expense is required falls under the Regulations on Government Medical Institutions (General Regulations 2000-2013).

ACTIVITY 3: Conduct epidemiological and other investigations

As part of the role of the Ministry of Health to draw up a strategy for oral health and update the epidemiological map of Cyprus, epidemiological surveys are conducted every 3-5 years to detect the level of oral health of the child population and every 5-7 years for adults. Based on the results of the investigations, the programs of the Preventive Sector are organized and enriched. Within the time period 2023-25

planning and implementation of the new epidemiological survey to determine the level of oral health of representative population groups from all age groups is expected to begin. The last survey with a sample from all age groups was done in 2014.

At the same time, the Dental Services will proceed with a quantitative and qualitative analysis of the statistical data in relation to the impact of the pandemic on the provision of dental care with the aim of carrying out interventions where necessary to ensure the readiness of the Dental Services to manage crises involving the public sector.

ACTIVITY 4: Preventive programs for school and preschool children and actions aimed at promoting oral health

The Prevention sector employs 5 dental operators, 4 dental office assistants and 4 drivers of the mobile dental unit. The OUs, in the context of implementing their goal of promoting oral health, will continue and intensify the existing preventive programs. Specifically, the following are planned:

- a) Visit of Mobile Dental Units to various schools of primary education, offering free preventive and therapeutic treatment, giving particular emphasis to schools located in remote areas with reduced access to dental care, as well as to schools located in low socio-economic areas level, where according to research data there are increased needs for both prevention and treatment. The program is expected to resume in the 2023-24 school year, following the pandemic.
- b) Inclusion in the caries early detection program beyond 6-year-old children (8,000 students) and all 5-year-old children, as well as a larger portion of 15-year-old children according to the results of the epidemiological survey.
- c) Inclusion in the programs for the early detection of caries and the promotion of oral health and a portion of children aged 3 and 4 who attend full-day public kindergartens.
- d) Investigating the possibility of expanding the cooperation program with the private sector and covering also D grade primary school students.
- e) Intensification of enlightenment regarding oral health, upgrading of printed material and organization campaign regarding oral cancer and its link with smoking, as well as a campaign regarding oral health and its link with general health.
- f) Promotion of oral health towards yet another vulnerable population group, that of the elderly as well as people with general illnesses who are bedridden. The goal is to create a manual and train the caregivers of these individuals regarding oral health and hygiene.

(g) Use of digital technology to inform citizens/notify message delivery/send health promotion messages/appointment reminders/obtain parental consent.

PERFORMANCE AND PERFORMANCE INDICATORS - DENTAL SERVICES

Objective (S) / Activity (D)	Performance Index (S) /Performance (D)	Index Results - 2021	Description
P.1: Ensuring a high level of oral health and providing dental care	<u>YE01</u> : Percentage of people without treatment needs (DT=0) and with healthy periodontal tissues (CPI=0), in terms of the total number of people included in the epidemiological surveys		Percentage of people from the age groups 6, 12, 15, 35-55 and 65-74 without treatment needs (Decayed teeth, DT=0) and with healthy periodontal tissues (CPI=0). No need for treatment means not needing conservative treatment eg fillings, endodontic treatments or extractions. Healthy periodontal tissues means no bleeding, tartar (tartar) or pockets on clinical examination
	<u>DE02</u> : Number of requests submitted to the OAU for compensation		Number of claims for dental treatments submitted to the OAU for reimbursement
IO1: Provision of high quality dental services in hospitals, urban and rural centres	<u>DA01</u> : Annual number of new patients visiting the EDs		New patient means the patient visiting the ICU for the first time
<u>D02</u> : Covering the cost of purchasing dental services for civil servants working in the Embassies/ Permanent Representations of the Republic abroad.	<u>DA02</u> : Annual number of requests for reimbursement of expenses		Number of requests from civil servants working in Embassies/Permanent Representations of the Republic abroad to cover the cost of dental care they receive abroad. The aim of the indicator is to track any variation change that may be observed in the number of requests over time and
<u>D03</u> : Conducting epidemiological and other investigations	<u>DA03</u> : Number of investigations carried out with the aim of developing a strategy to improve oral health		Epidemiological and other surveys aimed at recording the level of oral health of the citizens of Cyprus (the surveys will evaluate/record the following indicators: DMFT, OHI, CPI, prosthetic status, prosthetic needs) for the following age groups (6, 12, 14, 35-44, 65-74) but also seeking dental care.
<u>D04</u> : Preventive programs for children	<u>DA01</u> : Percentage of children receiving treatment		Percentage of children aged 5,6,11 and 15 receiving treatment after

of school and preschool age and actions aimed at promoting oral health	after diagnosis in the context of preventive programs for the early detection of oral diseases (screening programs)		diagnosis in the context of preventive programs for the early detection of oral diseases (screening programs)
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GRAPHIC SUMMARY 2024 - DENTAL SERVICES

DENTAL SERVICES - RECONCILIATION

DENTAL SERVICES - ON TARGET

DEPARTMENT: PHARMACEUTICAL SERVICES

OBJECTIVE 1: OBJECTIVE 1: ENSURING THE QUALITY, EFFECTIVENESS AND SAFETY OF MEDICINAL PRODUCTS

1. EXISTING CONDITION

Ensuring the quality, efficacy, safety and price of medicinal products for human use available to the public is a key concern for the promotion and protection of public health. Accordingly, ensuring the quality and safety of cosmetic products on the market is essential for consumer protection.

The Pharmaceutical Services, through their individual activities, aim to achieve the above by providing high quality evaluation services at pre-approval and post-approval level, as well as market inspection and control/surveillance services.

The licensing and regulation of the circulation of pharmaceutical products for human use by Pharmacies Services are legally established under the Medicines for Human Use (Control of Quality, Supply and Prices) Act, which is fully in line with the EU acquis.

Accordingly, the circulation and control of cosmetic products is governed by the provisions of the Cosmetic Products Law and the relevant Regulations

The licensing of pharmaceutical products for human use requires a thorough scientific evaluation of their quality, safety and effectiveness by suitably qualified pharmacists – experts of the Services, either through national procedures, or in cooperation with other EU member states through the centralized, decentralized or mutual recognition process.

It is pointed out that the long-term mission of the Services is to establish Cyprus as a competitive and attractive option for stakeholders in the European Union in order to increase the revenues of the Republic of Cyprus and expand professional specialization opportunities. Since January 1, 2020, Cyprus has assumed the role of Reference Member State in decentralized and mutual recognition procedures, performing full scientific evaluation of applications and contributing to the licensing and circulation of pharmaceutical products for human use in the EU member states. The assumption by Cyprus of the role of Reference Member State is expected to bring significant benefits for local pharmaceutical companies, which will benefit from competitive fees, it will no longer be necessary to turn to other Member States for the issuance of the relevant licenses and they will be in position to market their products in the other member states, thus expanding their turnover.

At the approval level, the Pharmaceutical Services are responsible for the systematic monitoring of the use and safety of pharmaceutical products for human use as well as for raising public awareness regarding their rational use, with the ultimate goal of protecting patients and increasing public knowledge of the benefits and risks of pharmacotherapies thus enabling them to make informed choices about their medication and minimizing any risks.

The inspection of domestic and third country manufacturing premises, licensed wholesalers and private pharmacies by the authorized pharmacist inspectors of the Services is an essential control/supervision function of pharmaceutical activities, with the aim of ensuring a high level of quality in the supply chain of pharmaceutical products for human use in market and in the prevention of unacceptable or even illegal practices.

Accordingly, the inspection of domestic manufacturing premises and market surveillance for cosmetic products by the authorized officers aims at effective protection and safety of consumers.

In addition, the Pharmaceutical Services is the competent authority for the inspection of clinical trials (medicines for human use) in Cyprus, ensuring the correct application of the new European Regulation on Clinical Trials and Good Clinical Practice. NHS officers are actively involved in the EU network and EU GCP inspections at international level. From the same department, Pharmacovigilance inspections are carried out to ensure that MAHs comply with all EU regulations and national legislation regarding pharmacovigilance requirements.

The Services also carry out controls for narcotic and psychotropic substances and issue relevant import licenses under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Law, while at the same time they are responsible for the registration of pharmacists in the respective register under the Pharmaceutical and Poisons Law.

Issues and policies related to the pricing of pharmaceutical products for human use, as well as the annual update of the price list of pharmaceutical products, are also the main responsibility of the Pharmaceutical Services. In addition, the Pharmaceutical Services support and participate in the implementation of the national Subsidy Plan for the Treatment of Infertility in Cyprus and manage the subsidy of specific pharmaceutical products used in IVF treatments in the context of a relevant decision of the Council of Ministers.

The Pharmaceutical Services, as part of their mission to ensure the quality, safety and effectiveness of pharmaceutical products, have adopted and implemented a Quality Management System for the majority of their responsibilities, which has been certified with the international standard ISO 9001:2015.

The Ministry of Health has designated the Pharmaceutical Services as the official body for Health Technology Assessment (Health Technology Assessment, HTA) regarding pharmaceutical products in Cyprus. The Pharmaceutical Services participate in all the programs offered by the European Commission for the implementation of the Regulation and will take all the actions required for full implementation. In addition, in order to ensure patients' access to innovative medicines, the provision of secretarial and scientific support to the Medicines Advisory Committee (SEF) is being studied so that it becomes a purely impartial committee.

The Pharmaceutical Services, anticipating the recognition of the services they offer at the European level as well as the continuous upgrading, actively participate in European EU4Health programs. Participation in these programs is expected to increase revenues in the Republic

It should be noted that the activities of the Pharmaceutical Services are not limited to the local level. The specialized staff of the Services systematically and actively participates in European and international networks (Committees and Working Groups of the European Medicines Agency, the Heads of Medicines Agency, etc.) effectively contributing to the evaluation and decision-making regarding pharmaceutical products for human use, promoting the convergence of regulatory standards and strengthening the cooperation and exchange of information between the competent authorities, while ensuring the safeguarding of national interests and the protection of public health.

2. ACTIVITIES

ACTIVITY 1: Ensuring the quality, effectiveness and safety of all pharmaceutical products before their licensing and importation in Cyprus and the member states.

The main actions related to the above activity are the following:

- i. Scientific evaluation of quality, efficacy and safety data of medicinal products for human use under application for a marketing authorization through a national process.
- ii. Scientific evaluation of quality, efficacy and safety data of pharmaceutical products for human use under application for a marketing authorization through a decentralized process or mutual recognition process with Cyprus as a Reference Member State. In these licensing procedures, the evaluation results are accepted by the other participating EU member states. and Cyprus contributes to the licensing and circulation of said products in other member states.
- iii. Scientific evaluation of quality, efficacy and safety data of pharmaceutical products for human use under application for a marketing authorization through a decentralized process or mutual recognition process where Cyprus participates as a Concerned Member State.
- iv. Taking on the role of rapporteur/ co-rapporteur/ reviewer for the scientific evaluation of quality, efficacy and safety data of medicinal products for human use that submit an application for a marketing authorization through a central procedure to the European Medicines Agency.
- v. Scientific evaluation of applications for renewal and modification of marketing authorizations for medicinal products for human use through national and mutual recognition procedures.
- vi. Approval of applications and issuance of marketing authorizations and renewals of marketing authorizations for pharmaceutical products and monitoring compliance with their terms and conditions Issuance of special marketing authorizations for pharmaceutical products and parallel import licenses
- vii. Preliminary assessment of requests to the Medicines Council and Council secretarial support Medicines.
- viii. Issuance of medicinal product certificates (CPP).
- ix. Control of OCABR certificates for biological medicinal products and medicinal products that are blood derivatives.
- x. Market sampling for compliance of pharmaceutical products on the Cypriot market with the conditions of their marketing authorization.
- xi. Active participation in the IncreaseNET European Joint Action to develop its capabilities European Network for the Regulation of Pharmaceutical Products.
- xii. Determination of the legal status of the distribution of pharmaceutical products.
- xiii. Systematic and active participation in the Mutual Recognition Process Coordination Group and Decentralized process.
- xiv. Systematic and active participation in the Committee for Medicinal Products for Human Use European Medicines Agency.
- xv. Systematic and active participation in European Committees and Working Groups, i.e. the Committees and Working Groups (WP) of the European Medicines Agency (EMA), the Heads of Medicines Agency (HMA) etc., as well as in international networks.
- xvi. Scientific evaluation of applications to conduct / modify clinical trials in Cyprus, monitoring their conduct and assessing their safety.

ACTIVITY 2: Monitoring the use and safety of pharmaceutical products for human use, after their licensing and circulation in Cyprus and in the member states.

The main actions related to the above activity are the following:

- i. Establish and implement procedures and upcoming safety measures for studies conducted after the marketing of medicinal products for human use, as well as evaluating Risk Minimization Measures (RMM) and undertaking additional

activities related to the rational use of medicines (e.g. educational material, information to health professionals and patients).

ii. Monitoring, collection, evaluation and reporting of adverse reactions and other data

safety by healthcare professionals and patients in European and international databases (eg: Eudravigilance). In addition, monitoring and responding to shortages of medicinal products for human use and evaluating the benefit-risk relationship, as well as implementing a signal detection and management system. iii. Monitoring the promotion and advertising activities of human pharmaceutical products

of use.

iv. Systematic and active participation in its Pharmacovigilance Risk Assessment Committee

European Medicines Agency (PRAC) with a contribution to the strengthening of pharmacovigilance in the European network and to the definition of methodology and measures for the monitoring of pharmaceutical products for human use and the immediate treatment and evaluation of safety issues.

ACTIVITY 3: Ensuring the quality and integrity of the supply chain of pharmaceuticals for human use through inspections of manufacturing premises, wholesale license holders, marketing authorization holders of pharmaceutical products, clinical trial sites and through audits of private pharmacies

The main actions related to the above activity are the following:

i. Inspections of domestic wholly or partially manufactured premises, third country importers and contract laboratories to ensure compliance with GMP

(Good Manufacturing Practice, GMP), to ensure compliance with relevant legal requirements and guidelines and practices.

ii. Inspections of wholesale license holders to ensure good distribution practice is applied

(Good Distribution Practice, GDP) and pharmacovigilance system inspection (GVPs), ensuring that quality and safe pharmaceutical products for human use are on the market.

iii. Inspections of manufacturing premises abroad and issuance of a European GMP certificate for the

Cypriot pharmaceutical industry, enhancing the adequacy of pharmaceutical products for human use in the local market.

iv. Issuance and renewal of manufacturing and import licenses from Third Countries, wholesale sales licenses,

issuance of Good Manufacturing Practice and Distribution certificates, updating the European EudraGMDP database.

v. Inspections for enrollment in

the register of persons acting as agents for human medicinal products

of use.

vi. Inspection of clinical trial facilities and inspection of clinical trials involving medicinal products (loaned or investigational

substances) for human use to ensure that good clinical practice guidelines are followed and implemented as well as ensuring the safety of all clinical trial participants.

vii. Inspections of Marketing Authorization Holders within the EU with a focus on those based in Cyprus, to ensure the application of Good Pharmacovigilance

Practice, GVP), to ensure compliance with relevant legal requirements and guidelines and practices.

viii. Conducting sampling within the framework of the annual program as well as extraordinary investigations for the post-

authorization quality control of pharmaceutical products for human use that are circulating on the Cypriot market (post authorization quality control).

- ix. Supervision of the effective implementation of the European Regulation 2016/161 on Characteristics Security.
- x. Handling two-way Rapid Alerts with other EU member states, the EEC, and the states that have entered into MRA mutual recognition agreements regarding quality problems of pharmaceutical products for human use.
- xi. Participation in European and international campaigns to combat the illegal circulation of counterfeit or unlicensed pharmaceutical products for human use.
- xii. Systematic and active participation in European and international Committees and Working Groups, i.e PIC/S Steering Committee, the European Medicines Agency Inspectorate Working Groups GMDP IWG, GCP IWG and PhVIWG, the HMA Working Group, WGEO (Working Group of Enforcement Officers).
- xiii. Inspections of over 600 private pharmacies, certifying that pharmacists practice the profession in accordance with legal requirements, while at the same time ensuring that pharmacy premises meet the high standards set and the safe and under controlled conditions of safekeeping/storage of pharmaceutical products for human use.
- xiv. Control of drugs and psychotropic substances (issuance of licenses to companies, clinics and tourists, inspections of clinics holding Drugs) Investigation of consumer complaints and reports of illegal activities in relation to pharmaceuticals for human use.
- xv. Supervision of the training/practice program of the candidate pharmacists in Cyprus and cooperation with other regulatory European bodies regarding the recognition of the training/practice programs in other EU member states.
- xvi. Conducting examinations for obtaining a license to practice the pharmaceutical profession on a quarterly basis with 2 topics: namely legislation and pharmaceutical practice, ensuring the adequate training of pharmacists.

ACTIVITY 4: Ensuring the quality and safety of cosmetic products through inspections at production premises and through market surveillance

The main actions related to the above activity are the following:

- i. Inspections of fully or partially manufactured domestic real estate, to ensure the implementation of rules of good industrial practice, ensuring that quality and safe cosmetics are placed on the market, in accordance with relevant legal requirements and European guidelines and practices.
- ii. Editions, Renewals, Amendments of Licenses for the Manufacture of Cosmetic Products.
- iii. Conducting physical checks of cosmetic products in various premises, as part of market surveillance, to verify their compliance with European and National Legislation.
- iv. Conduct sampling as part of the annual program as well as ad hoc inspections to investigate complaints related to cosmetic products.
- v. Monitoring of the European RAPEX information exchange system on cosmetic products and relevant public information through Press Releases.
- vi. Participation in meetings of the European Commission Standing Committee on Cosmetics and the European Working Group on Cosmetics, as well as the CD-P-COS working group of the Council of Europe.
- vii. Participation in domestic and European information and consumer awareness campaigns regarding cosmetic products.
- viii. Issuance of Certificates of Free Circulation of Cosmetic Products (Free Sales Certificates) for cosmetic export purposes.

ACTIVITY 5: Management of the Pricing system for pharmaceutical products for human use

The main actions related to the above activity are the following:

- i. Management and support of pharmaceutical invoicing processes
- ii. Administration of a drug (gonadotropin) subsidy scheme for the treatment of infertility
- iii. Preparation and publication of supplementary price lists of medicinal products for human use
- iv. Annual update of the uniform price list of medicinal products for human use
- v. Evaluation study of the pricing policy every 2 years
- vi. Maintaining a price register of Non-Prescription Medicinal Products
- vii. Active participation in European price monitoring networks, in order to respond promptly to their changes prices and the differences in pricing practices that occur in the E.U
- viii. Participation in the European drug pricing network with interest benefit from experience and specialization of authorities that have well organized billing systems

Note: The above strategic planning of the Pharmaceutical Services is based on the planning that was in force in the Strategic Plan of the previous period, pending the completion of the reforms and until a political decision is made on the establishment of the National Pharmaceutical Authority.

PERFORMANCE AND PERFORMANCE INDICATORS - PHARMACEUTICAL SERVICES

Objective (S) / Activity (D)	Performance Index (S) /Performance (D)		Description
P1: Ensuring the quality, effectiveness, safety and prices of pharmaceutical products for human use as well as the quality and safety of cosmetic products	DE01: Responsiveness to all interested parties regarding issues of quality, effectiveness, safety and prices of pharmaceutical products for human use as well as quality and safety of cosmetic products		Determining Services' response to any issues of and concerns raised by interested parties regarding the scope of Services' activities Indicator in Binary format – Yes/No
D01: Evaluation of the quality, effectiveness and safety of pharmaceutical products in the context of their licensing in Cyprus and in the member states	YA01: Processing applications for marketing authorizations for medicinal products for human use through the National Procedure		The planned timetable, according to the current Legislation, for the completion of the planned procedure for applications for marketing authorization for pharmaceutical products through the National Procedure is 210 days (clock stop). Indicator=number of applications processed within the schedule / total number of applications
D02: Monitoring of the use and safety of pharmaceutical products for human use, after their licensing and circulation in Cyprus and in the member states so as to relate to a Performance Indicator which is monitored within the framework of the Quality Management System:	YA02: Evaluation and registration of reports of suspected adverse events (AEs) on an annual basis		The planned schedule (GVP Module VI) for the completion of the process of evaluation and registration of reports of suspected AEs in Eudragilance is for serious AEs within 15 days and for non-serious AEs within 90 days from the receipt of the reports. Indicator i) number of reports of suspected serious AEs processed within schedule/Total number of suspected serious AEs received annually of ii) number of reports of suspected non-serious AEs processed within the schedule/ Total number of suspected non-serious AEs received on an annual basis DA03i. It refers to the annual number of inspections of manufacturing facilities and wholesale license holders
D03: Ensuring the quality and integrity of the supply chain of pharmaceutical products for human use through	YA03i: Registration of the number of inspections on manufacturing premises and holders of a license to wholesale pharma. human products		compared to the annual inspection plan (Note: The annual plan includes the annual planning based on relevant

inspections of manufacturing premises, wholesale license holders, marketing authorization holders of pharmaceutical products, clinical trial sites and through inspections in private pharmacies	of use, and clinical trial sites on an annual basis DA03ii: Registration of the number of inspections of private pharmacies on an annual basis	risk assessment, new applications as well as extraordinary investigations) Index i = Annual number of inspections of manufacturing premises, third country importers, contract laboratories, clinical trial sites and wholesale license holders / Determined number of inspections according to an annual plan DA03ii Refers to the annual number of inspections of private pharmacies compared to the annual inspection plan and the resulting complaints (Note: The annual plan concerns 1 inspection/pharmacy/3 years) Indicator ii = Number of inspections of private pharmacies / Determined number of inspections of private pharmacies according to an annual plan
D04: Ensuring the quality and safety of cosmetic products through inspections at production premises and through market surveillance	DA04: Registration of the number of inspections on domestic premises manufacturing cosmetic products on an annual basis DA04ii: Registration of the number of cosmetic products tested on an annual basis	It refers to the annual number of inspections of premises manufacturing cosmetic products compared to the annual inspection plan (Note: The annual plan includes the annual planning based on a relevant risk assessment, new applications as well as extraordinary investigations) Indicator = Annual number of inspections of premises manufacturing cosmetic products / Total number of inspections according to annual plan Indicator = Annual number of cosmetics cosmetic where tested/number of products to be tested according to the annual plan
D05: Management of the Pricing system for pharmaceutical products for human use	DA05i: Processing requests for invoicing of medicinal products for human use on an annual basis	The prescribed time frame under the current Legislation to complete the prescribed price setting process for pharmaceutical products is 90 days Indicator = number of price setting requests processed within 90 days / total number of requests submitted and considered
	DA05ii: Processing of applications for drug funding for IVF treatments received in the given year compared to the previous year	It refers to the annual number of requests for drug subsidy for treatments of IVF who have received the subsidy to be evaluated the level of demand and budget the next year's needs

GRAPHIC SUMMARY 2024 - PHARMACEUTICAL SERVICES

PHARMACEUTICAL SERVICES - RECONCILIATION

PHARMACEUTICAL SERVICES - ON TARGET

DEPARTMENT: STATE GENERAL CHEMISTRY**OBJECTIVE 1: PREVENT AND PROTECT CONSUMER SAFETY, ENVIRONMENT AND
POLICE SUPPORT****1. EXISTING CONDITION**

The General State Chemistry (GCHK) is the official state laboratory for chemical, microbiological, biological, toxicological and radiological analyzes and the official National Control Center for Food and Materials in contact with food, Water, Waste, Environmental samples, illegal drugs etc. Police Evidence, Children's Toys, Medicines, Cosmetics and other Consumer Products. It is also the National Reference Laboratory for several fields related to food safety (Regulation (EC) 2017/625). Cyprus has to play an additional role as a critical point of entry and control of food imported into the European Union (EU) from Third Countries, especially from the East, as once the products pass through the Cypriot market, they can be freely traded in the market of the EU

GCHK employs 147 people in various jobs, of which 115 are scientists (Chemists/ Biologists/ Microbiologists), who hold scientific degrees on a permanent or temporary basis. It is reported that 13 of the 115 scientific positions are vacant. It is noteworthy that 75% of the scientific staff holds a postgraduate degree. Twelve (12) people belong to the exchangeable staff and 20 people are hourly employees.

The GCHK consists of 21 laboratories under 7 Sectors. Its activities are included in the framework of Annual and Multi-Year Control Programs (CCP) monitoring and surveillance, in accordance with the relevant European and National Legislation. Therefore, during the redesign of the PPEs, new parameters are included, mainly concerning new emerging risks, and the number of analyzed samples is increased. During 2021, a total of 24,050 samples were analyzed within the framework of the PPE and despite the existence of the corona virus pandemic and the measures implemented by the Competent Authorities, the numbers compare favorably with the numbers of samples analyzed before the pandemic, as well as with other EU countries. Estimates for 2022 are currently considered similar or even improved.

The effectiveness of the PPE is considered satisfactory, since the main objective is to identify unsuitable products on import or before they enter the market, where it is possible to apply, as well as the reduction of non-compliant samples with the relevant legislation. Out of the total of 24,050 samples above, approximately 7,610 related to food samples, of which only 2.3% were outside the requirements of the relevant legislation, despite the emerging phenomena of fraudulent practices and degraded products due to the economic crisis and the pandemic, climate changes, etc. A small decrease in the number of non-compliances is observed in relation to the fluctuations of previous years (2.5-4.4%, between the years 2008-2020). A fact that further contributes to ensuring the consumption of safe and healthy food in Cyprus and can be seen as the first prevention for the protection of public health. These food control and surveillance programs are carried out in collaboration with the National Competent Authorities and cover the entire food chain "from the field or farm to the consumer's plate".

In the case of environmental monitoring and monitoring, this focuses on water resources, air, soil and waste, as well as human biomonitoring in relation to environmental impacts on human health.

As the official laboratory for the examination of police evidence, the scientific results of forensic chemistry provide the basis for the Police to solve police cases. In addition, it provides scientific support to the General Prosecutor's Office for the administration of justice. During 2021, 5,068 evidence and toxicological samples were received. There is an increase in the number of documents compared to previous years.

Applied research is an important pillar for the continuous scientific and technological development of the State General Chemistry. The research conducted contributes to solving and preventing problems, shaping policy and legislation. The main areas of research cover food, water, environment and health safety, the authenticity of food and drink and their geographical origin, the safety of other non-food products as well as drugs. The research is financed through National and European funds through competitive procedures. Since 2004, G.H.K. has absorbed a total amount of more than 10 million euros, including the project within the framework of the Recovery and Resilience Plan.

The GHK continuously expands its European and International collaborations in order to maintain its developmental and worthy course in European becoming, to strengthen its infrastructure and to strengthen its contribution. This is achieved through strengthening its international networking and cooperation with universities, European research centers and other relevant bodies in order to promote the exchange of scientists, joint research actions as well as the transfer of know-how, with the aim of developing it into a Center Excellence at Regional and European level.

GHK has been accredited in 2002 according to the international EN ISO/IEC 17025 standard by the Hellenic Accreditation System (ESYD). Its accreditation documents the reliability and integrity of its results. Since 2014, the GHK has transferred its accreditation to the National Accreditation Body (NAB), continuously expanding its scope of accreditation and, by extension, its expertise. It also disseminates its knowledge and expertise to other Departments, National Institutes and Organizations of the private sector in relation to Quality Assurance, the Accreditation process and risk assessment.

The Greek Ministry of Health has substantially upgraded the Risk Assessment Unit so that, after evaluating its results, it carries out the necessary risk assessment, in order to confirm the degree of exposure of the general population and especially children to various risks (chemical, microbiological/biological, radiological, etc.). It provides scientifically based advice to the competent authorities facilitating risk management and taking effective measures. The Risk Assessment Unit (RAU) also provides scientific support to the Food Safety Board and its activities are supported by the European Food Safety Authority (EFSA). The GHK participates in the EFSA Advisory Body, is the Contact Point with EFSA and also participates in the various EFSA and EU networks. In the context of his activities, he developed with funding from EFSA, reputable risk assessment tools that have been adopted by other states. The expertise of the FGD staff is also disseminated to other Member States, since EFSA often invites FGD experts as trainers in training programs for the Member States.

The electronic transmission to EFSA of the analytical data produced by the FGD, which requires defined coding and special software, is carried out by the FGD IT Unit (MP). MP works closely with MEK, in order to contribute to its further development, as well as to the upgrading of the infrastructures of the GHK.

Although the GHK is a dynamically developing organization, its existing facilities create obstacles to its scientific development. The existing building, built in 1970 (according to the requirements of that time), has not been built with anti-seismic specifications and therefore needs constant maintenance and further safety measures. In addition, the existing building facilities are not sufficient and for this reason it is difficult to expand the scope of activities of the laboratories, which in many cases is mandatory, both through EU legislation and the requirements of the accreditation standard. The construction of new facilities for the GHK is in full swing, since the announcement of the architectural competition by the Department of Public Works for the start of the project in 2023 is expected soon.

Cyprus, due to its strategic geopolitical position, has an important role to play on the easternmost borders of the EU and this capacity must be strengthened in the GFK. The regional role of the JRC will bring added value to the EU.

The GHK has an important contribution, as a State Counselor, responding in a timely and valid manner to crises and problems that arise in matters of its responsibilities. It is also responsible for monitoring and dealing with emerging risks and crises. For its timely response in a highly scientific manner, it must continuously develop its human resources and maintain state-of-the-art equipment. OR

its response is reflected through flexibility, accountability and proper governance which need continuous development.

The development of human resources is of prime importance for an organization such as the CGK, so that it is constantly updated on the new requirements of legislation and analytical methods, new skills and approaches. As the National Reference Laboratory in the field of Food (Regulation (EC) 2017/625) and the Official National Control Laboratory for environmental samples, medicines, cosmetics and drugs, the continuous upgrading of its know-how and expertise is a prerequisite for maintaining inputs and outputs at a high scientific level and at the same time promotes the European role of Cyprus in the region.

2. ACTIVITIES RELATED TO OBJECTIVE 1

Activity 1: Surveillance/Monitoring/Official Control of Food, Water, Medicines and Other Consumer Products

For this activity, **Multi-Year Control Programs (MCPs) are planned**, in accordance with the requirements of the relevant EU legislation.

More specifically, more than sixty specialized control programs are drawn up and implemented annually in the following fields:

- Food
- Drinking water and other water sources
- Environmental Control (air, sea and waste)
- Medicines and Cosmetics
- Children's Toys and other industrial products

Every year, after the completion of the control programs, they are evaluated for their contribution and effectiveness through their results and feedback from the Competent Authorities. This provides the basis for planning and organizing next year's control programs/based on risk prioritization based on the needs of the legislation and the findings of previous years or other K.M. The programs are enriched and revised, in terms of control parameters and the number of analyzed samples, and are signed every year.

The long-term monitoring of the number of analyzed samples, which are determined in the control programs in cooperation with the Competent Authorities, as well as the number of analyzed samples that deviate from the requirements of the legislation are an indicator of the protection of public health and the environment.

In addition to the samples received, an increased number of samples are analyzed with the aim of maintaining quality and continuous development. In order to continue to contribute to the improvement of the quality of life by providing reliable and high quality services, the GHK must maintain and expand its accreditation in order to simultaneously become capable of assuming its role as a regional Center of Excellence and as a Reference Center in the fields of his responsibilities.

The training of human resources is a primary need for the GHK. Staff participation in internal and external trainings ensures continuous development.

The Risk Assessment Unit and the Informatics Unit (IT) contribute significantly to the evaluation of analytical data and the conduct of food risk assessment. The development and completion of the upgrade of the risk assessment tool "Improrisk" by the Risk Assessment Unit of the GHK, will lead to the extraction of more comprehensive and representative results, for the degree of exposure of the Cypriot consumer to dangerous substances contained in the food they consume. This assessment will allow for more targeted and effective interventions to remove nutritional risks.

In addition, prevention is a key pillar for ensuring the health of consumers and therefore the GHK places particular importance on educating the public and/or the cooperating agencies by publishing information forms, organizing seminars, lectures, etc.

Activity 2: Analysis of Police Evidence

For this activity, a large amount of police evidence is received for analysis by the CGK, including narcotics. A continued increase in the number of evidence, particularly of new synthetic drugs, as well as drug testing controls is foreseen. Analyses of police evidence cannot be included in the basis of a program, since they are unpredictable and completely dependent on the crime in the state, thus making the organization of the work of the laboratory difficult and unpredictable.

To maintain quality and extend accreditation, an increased number of samples are analyzed in this activity as well, and in addition, the staff participates in internal and external trainings to ensure continuous development.

The monitoring of the response of the laboratory in the timely realization of the analysis of the evidence contributes to the immediate support of the work of the Police. Therefore, monitoring the time that elapses from the receipt of evidence of police cases to the start of the analysis is an important indicator for the timely realization of the analyses.

Activity 3: Research and Innovation

Existing research actions (National and European such as Horizon 2020 of the EU) will continue. Research actions co-funded by social resources are expected to reach nine, including action under the Recovery and Resilience Plan.

In the context of the **Recovery and Resilience Plan**, the GHK has secured funding for the project "Strengthening the existing isotopic databases of Cypriot local and traditional foods/drinks, with the development of a Block Chain platform, to ensure their identity". The GHK has installed the new system for the holistic control of traditional food/beverages by 2021, in accordance with the requirements of the Plan

Recovery and Resiliency, and the development of the platform for the implementation of the Block Chain is expected until 2024. The GHK thus contributes to strengthening the entrepreneurship and competitiveness of agri-food businesses, in the domestic and international markets, by determining the authenticity of local and traditional products (wine, honey, fruit juices, alcoholic beverages) as well as adulteration (honey) , olive oil, vinegar, dairy).

In addition, the submission of new proposals for participation in competitive research programs at national and European level is a priority of the CGK and aims at its development and establishment in the international arena.

The increase in the number of successful research actions that are implemented is an indicator of the promotion of research by the Directorate of the GHK.

PERFORMANCE AND PERFORMANCE INDICATORS – STATE GENERAL CHEMISTRY

Objective (S) / Activity (D)	Performance Index (S) / Performance (D)	2021 Index Results	Description
<u>S1:</u> Prevention and Protection of Consumer Safety, Environment and support of the Police	<u>DE01:</u> The number of non-compliant samples each year		The number of analyzed samples in which the analysis result does not conform to a specification or regulation or standard.
<u>D01:</u> Surveillance/monitoring official control of food, water, drugs and other consumer products	<u>DA01:</u> The number of samples analyzed each year		The number of samples received and analyzed each year.
<u>D02:</u> Analysis of police evidence	<u>DA02:</u> The time from receipt of the sample to the start of the analysis		Average length of time from the date of receipt of the evidence of the police case until the start of the analysis
<u>D03:</u> Research and Innovation	<u>DA03:</u> The number of successful European research innovation projects funded		The number of successful funded research innovative programs per year

GRAPHIC SUMMARY 2024 - STATE GENERAL CHEMISTRY

STATE GENERAL CHEMISTRY - RECONCILIATION